

国际学术会议 实用英语教程

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Practical English for
International Academic Conferences



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前言

在我国经济建设、科技创新步入高速发展轨道并取得伟大成就的时代背景下,未来我国科技人才融入并引领世界科技创新、拥有各自领域的话语权,已势不可挡。目前,在各大高校为实现“高等教育强国”的战略发展目标而进行的“双一流”建设过程中,高水平的研究生教育是其中的一个重要特征。以国际化、研究型、高层次人才为培养目标,如何提升来自不同学科背景的硕士和博士研究生以英语为工具进行专业学习和国际学术交流的能力,如何培养一批有创新能力、适应经济社会发展需求、适应国际化教育的高素质技术人才,已成为目前研究生公共外语教学改革的方向与重点。同时,也给研究生英语教学提出了更高的要求,研究生英语教学要更务实、更具实操性,且凸显其高阶与前沿的特征。

“模拟国际会议”是近年来教学改革和实践过程中非英语专业研究生学位课程的一个重要部分,其目的是为了达到研究生英语教学大纲总则所规定的“在教学中要坚持从实际出发学以致用原则,培养提高研究生运用英语的能力”。为此,我们集结了“双一流”高校长期从事研究生和本科生学术交流英语教学的一线教师和专家,以服务建设“双一流”高校为总体目标,借鉴了东南大学研究生英语教学部 10 年的教改经验,结合教学实践需求以及研究生学术发展和就业需求,编写了《国际学术会议实用英语教程》。本教材共九个单元,以国际学术会议的主要交流活动为线索,融合国际会议信息、国际会议发言、学术演讲技能,集英语听、说、读、写等技能于一体,全面体现国际学术会议交流与国际会议英语的实际应用。前四个单元主要介绍了参与学术会议所需的基本技能和信息,第一单元和第二单元开展了学术演讲基本技能训练,第三单元详述了学术会议的各个议程,第四单元则指导学生如何进行学术会议的投稿。第五至第九单元围绕

国际会议的五个主要环节而展开,即开幕致辞、介绍主旨发言人、主旨发言、问答环节和闭幕致辞。本教材在编写时,根据党的二十大精神对具体内容做了一些调整。

本书既可作为高等院校研究生公共英语教材,也可作为具有中、高级英语水平的高校教师、研究机构学者以及其他有相关英语学习需求的社会专业人士参与国际学术交流提供系统性指导和训练。

本教材各单元主要包含以下板块与内容:

1. 学习目标 (Learning objectives): 明确学术会议各环节的特异性要求,以及各单元语言技能要求。

2. 技能信息/文本结构 (Skills or information / Structure): 通过基础知识和基本技能的讲解、范文展示和分析,以及任务设计,使学生了解参与国际学术会议所需的主要演讲技能、会议流程和各环节文本的基本构成要素。

3. 文化提醒 (Cultural notes): 结合国际会议各环节的跨文化交际特点,充分体现了课程思政元素,加强学生“四个自信”的培养。

4. 语言要点 (Language focus): 从范文和参会实践中提炼出相关语言要点,并提供足够的语言素材,作为“脚手架”,为后续的任务和项目提供支持。

5. 学期项目 (Project): 本课程最终的物化成果或终结性评价对象是每个学习小组组织和参与的一个完整模拟学术会议。本教材把学期项目的具体任务分解到各个单元,学生在完成每个单元学习任务的同时,也完成了各自小组项目的一个部分。学期结束时,每个小组则可展示出一个完整的模拟会议流程。

本教材编写特色:

1. 任务导向

本书弱化了学术报告相关的知识、理论讲解内容,课文和练习的编排为任务导向型教学服务,让学生通过完成各种任务掌握相关理论知识和技能。

2. 项目驱动

学生最终的学习目标是参与和组织一场模拟学术会议,即“学期项目”。每位学生需要结合自己的项目内分工,应用所学的知识和技能,和其他组员合作,共同呈现出一场模拟学术会议。“学期项目”是本教材所有任务的主线。

3. 过程控制

过程控制是形成性评价的一部分。学生可根据 Checklist 检查自己的任务完成情况。教师则可以检查每个环节讲稿写作、演讲练习等情况,并给予反馈,以便学生及时调整。

4. 课程思政

本书充分挖掘思政元素,比如范文、任务中包含大量中国元素,文化提醒中也涉及中国元素,以此帮助学生树立“四个自信”。

在本书编写过程中,我们查阅和参考了大量国内外教学理论资料 and 同类教材,并在吸取其他教材优点的基础上,尽可能突出本教材的特色。如有疏漏之处,恳请同行和使用者不吝赐教和反馈,为我们今后的修订和完善提供依据。

编者

2022 年 6 月

于南京九龙湖畔

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Unit 1

The Ingredients of a Great Presentation

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To identify three ingredients of making a presentation;
- To assess strengths and weaknesses of a presentation;
- To use visual aids effectively;
- To recognize the importance of non-verbal communication;
- To understand different types of non-verbal language.



THREE INGREDIENTS

A presentation is a mixture of three aspects: content, design, and delivery. To make a presentation great, there must be synergy of these three items. It is crucial to understand that you can't expect a successful presentation unless each of these carries equal weight and importance. You have to know what your audience wants and prepare good, interesting and engaging content. You need to spend hours designing the visual aids, and have to know how to manage your environment successfully. You must be confident in presenting the materials, and need to make sure that your message has maximum impact.

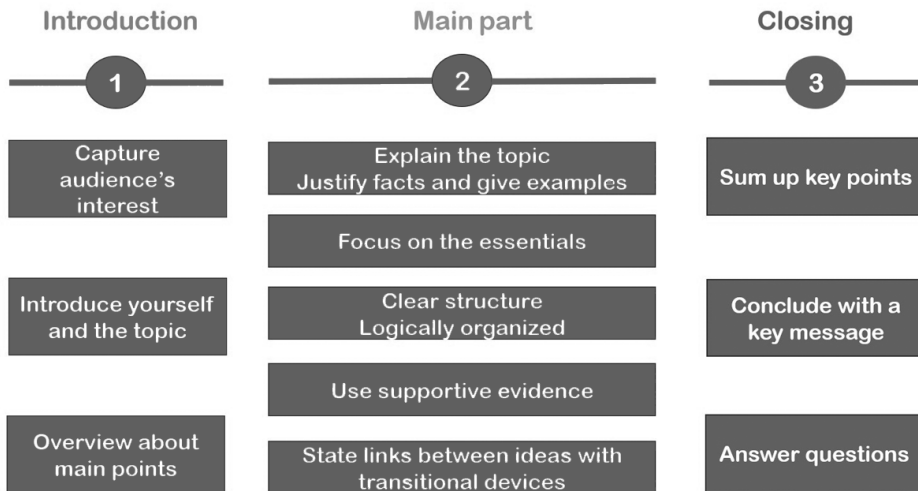
Content—Structuring Your Presentation

Content reflects your knowledge of the subject matter. It deals with the message and the story that you want to communicate, and how they are structured. Because it plays an important role in connecting you with your audience, it should be well-researched, genuine, precise, and contextual. While preparing the content of your presentation, you need to know the answers to the following questions:

- What is the objective of the presentation: to report, to argue, to compare, to convince, to question ...?
- What is the central idea of the presentation?
- What are the main arguments or ideas? Are they supported with relevant evidence?
- How shall I demonstrate my knowledge of the subject?
- Is the level of technicality suited to the audience?
- What questions are likely to be prompted by my presentation? How do I reply to audience's questions?

After you've formed a general idea of how your presentation is going to flow, you need to create a clear outline for your presentation in order that the audience should be able to follow you easily. Most presentations are organized according to a predictable pattern with three main sections: introduction, body and

conclusion, i.e., telling the audience what you are going to say, then saying it, and finally telling them what you have said. A well-structured presentation not only enhances the audience's comprehension but also keeps the speaker stay on the topic.



Start with an introduction where you capture the audience's interest in your topic and establish rapport with them—what you can possibly say or do that will hook the audience into your presentation such as using a question, quotation, anecdote, or interesting statistic, etc., state the key message or argument, and give them an outline of your presentation—what the main points are and what the order is in which you will cover them.

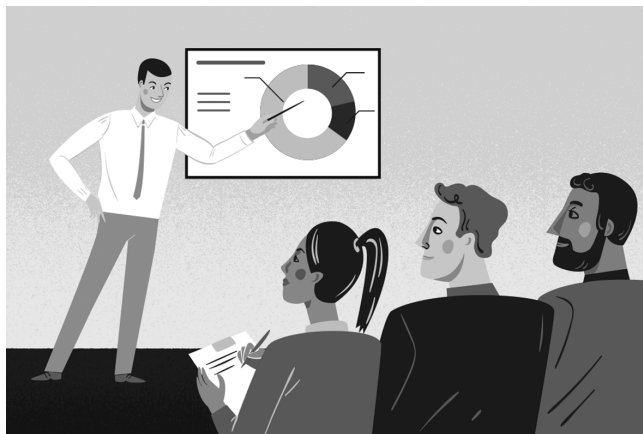
The body is where you expand and qualify your key ideas or arguments in more detail, using supporting evidence. Depending on the time limit, you need to be selective in the body where you may wish to cover only the most relevant and interesting points in a logical and coherent order, such as chronological, topical, cause and effect, comparison and contract, or problem-solution orders. Any idea which is new to audience needs to be presented with supportive evidence by referring to experts, providing examples, statistics, facts, case studies, etc. It is also important to state the links between your ideas clearly with transitional devices to help the audience follow the direction of your talk: *firstly...*; *secondly...*; *another important point is...*; *on the other hand, ...*; *I would now*

like to move on to another aspect of the research ...

To wrap up your presentation, think of a way you can reinforce the central ideas of the presentation and signal a forceful ending—reiterating the key points, concluding with a key message and if possible, setting your discussion in a wider context. It is important to have a strong conclusion so the audience is left with a good impression.

Design—Using Visuals to Your Advantage

Design deals with the whole “feel” to the presentation. It mostly involves using effective visual aids—the slides and the graphical enhancements. The presentation design must be both beautiful and effective; a beautiful design gives a creative look to the slideshow, while an effective design makes your content clear and comprehensible, evoking emotions in the audience and encouraging them to take action. Design could also be about how the presentation environment is—the décor of the room, the seating arrangements, IT/projection facilities and flip-charts or whiteboards for feedback.



For most presenters, it is now common to use presentation software such as PowerPoint. The following rules will help ensure the effective use of this type of visual aid:

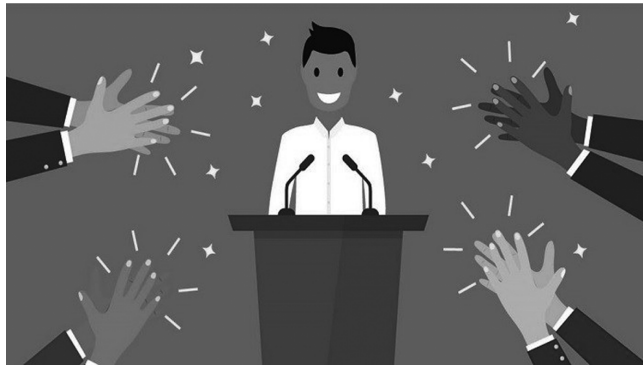
- **PowerPoint slides are not the platform for a manuscript.** You don't want to cram entire paragraphs on your slides and read aloud simply what you have

written. It is incredibly boring and uninspiring for the audience to read full sentences in the slides while listening to someone talk. You're the expert of the topic of your talk, not just the robot-reader of a text. Use the slides like they're supposed to be used—as visual aids, not a verbatim account. Write as little as possible. Use graphics and pictures to support your message, not to replace it.

- **Make PowerPoint slides readable and understandable.**

- Use one slide for each idea or point. You need to make sure people at the back can still make out the text on your screen, especially when you're presenting in a large room. This is why writing down only one idea per slide really shines.
- Use bullets to highlight individual points. Too much text will be distracting to the audience from your presentation as they attempt to read the slides. Bullet points which highlight the most important words and concepts are easily readable from the back of the room.
- Use large fonts. The smallest text font that is barely acceptable is 18-point; 28-point is better, and 32-point is best. There is a natural hierarchy of font sizes for a text slide—customarily, 44-point font for titles, 32-point font for main headings, 24 – 28-point font for subheadings or text.
- Use only one font style throughout the presentation. While it's best to keep the font type consistent from one slide to the next, it is acceptable to use italics or boldface for emphasis. Too many variations in font size and type can be visually confusing.
- Follow “The Rule of Seven”. Limit text on a slide to no more than 7 words per line, and no more than 7 lines per slide.
- Use the same colour scheme throughout the presentation for titles, text, and background. Altering the colour scheme from one slide to the next is distracting to the audience. Do not mix colours within a text sentence. Use no more than three different colours per slide. Choose colour combinations that contrast well for background and text. Low-contrasting colours can be readable on-screen but wash out when projected on a large screen.

Delivery—Leveraging Your Body Language



Delivery deals with how you voice your message, the tone of voice, and how you react to the audience. It is the way in which you use your own personal resources. The audience will make judgments about you even before you start to speak by the way you come across and how you look, and will continue to form opinions about you by the way you speak.

To create a great presentation, you need more than an interesting topic or the perfect PowerPoint template. While those things are important, there is one more ingredient that you need—your body language.

Too often, we see presenters sit on a stage with a bunch of slides and statistics without moving, or read PPT slides or notes without having eye contact with the audience. They don't know that the majority of what is put across is derived from the non-verbal communication. Communication, on a face-to-face basis, is thought to consist of three separate elements:

- Words (what is actually said)
- Tone of voice (how we say the words)
- Body language

All three elements can be conveyed at the same time to express an overall message. Often, the tone of voice and body language are combined to become the most powerful mode of communication. For instance, a man asks a woman if she is enjoying herself while they are having a date. Though the woman feels she isn't having a good time, she replies "yes, I'm having a really nice time" to appear polite. The literal meaning of the words conveys that she is enjoying herself,

the tone of voice she uses in conjunction with her body language, however, betrays her words. Her monotone voice shows boredom and lack of enthusiasm, and her restless and awkward posture may also express that she is not enjoying herself. The two non-verbal communication elements may give away the fact that she isn't having a nice time though she says she is.

However, body language, which forms a large part of non-verbal communication, is thought to be one of the most "telling" modes of communication. Body language refers to the way your body communicates without the use of words. The eye contact you make, the gestures you use, the facial expressions you wear, the way you are dressed, and your every movement through a room all offer a multitude of nonverbal signals to your audience.

- **Make eye contact.** In any presentation, most of your "talk time" should be conducted while you're making eye contact with your audience. Maintaining eye contact helps you build rapport with others. One mistake many presenters often make is staring at the back of the room. Avoiding eye contact prevents the audience from engaging with you. When looking at your notes, slides, or any other place than your audience, you should not be talking. Any time you are communicating information, you should be looking at an audience member. Obviously, you can't look at every single person, but you can scan the audience and make eye contact with individuals throughout your presentation. When you look at someone, be sure to hold the gaze for a few seconds. Good eye contact helps you assess how your audience is perceiving your message and also makes you look far more credible and trustworthy.
- **Pay attention to facial expressions.** Your facial expressions are a critical component of becoming an expressive speaker. The movements of your eyes, mouth, and facial muscles can build a connection with your audience. Your facial expressions can convey a variety of emotions and can demonstrate your passion for the subject. Don't be afraid to smile and use your facial expressions to relay your enthusiasm and excitement, and to reinforce and support your key points and ideas. Just as presenters are encouraged to expand their vocal range to avoid a monotone presentation, so too is it important to avoid a static expression throughout your entire presentation.
- **Correct body posture.** It's hard to think of a single situation where slouching

would be advised—and a presentation is no exception. A poor posture such as slouching will give your audience the impression that you're not confident nor interested in your topic or yourself. Remind yourself to relax throughout your presentation and to straighten up if you start to slouch. The correct presentation posture if you are standing is to:

- Square your shoulders with the audience;
- Stand tall;
- Relax your stance. You are not standing at attention;
- Face the audience directly instead of tilting your body away from them.

(The exception is when you are soliciting feedback from your audience. In that case, turning your body at a slight angle can encourage engagement.)

- **Speak with your hands.** A gesture is a specific bodily movement that reinforces a verbal message or conveys a particular thought or emotion. Although gestures may be made with the head, shoulders, or even the legs and feet, most are made with the hands and arms. Research shows that using hand gestures increases the value of your message by a whopping 60%. Intentional, well-timed hand gestures can show your audience that you care about the topic and that you're a knowledgeable and effective communicator. On the flipside, unintentional hand gestures can easily cause distraction and make you look nervous or unprofessional and even annoying.

Gestures generally fall into the following categories. Descriptive gestures help describe things like the size or shape of objects you're discussing. Locative gestures are used to indicate where something is or what direction something might be going. Emphatic gestures underscore what you're saying. They show strong emotion about something such as a clenched fist that might show anger or determination. Suggestive gestures help you convey ideas and emotions like shrugging shoulders that might suggest some irony in what you're saying. Transitional gestures are used to move your audience from one idea to the next or to enumerate things. Prompting gestures are a good way to ask your audience to participate or respond. If you want them to raise their hands, for example, you may raise your hand to show them well.

- **Consider your clothes.** Appearance alone doesn't make the speech, but it does determine the image the audience forms of you and may highlight your

confidence and professionalism. Your appearance should be formal, so avoid casual clothes and stick to professional dress codes. When choosing your clothes, also make sure that they are rather unobtrusive. Your audience should focus on your presentation, not on your appearance. Be aware that your clothes can project a high authority image, a neutral image, or a low authority image. Dress the way you would like the audience to perceive you. Remember to dress for the audience and not for yourself. This means taking into account the demographics of the audience—age, education, economic standing, profession—as well as their cultural expectations. Before you go to make a presentation, ask yourself:

—Are your clothes enhancing your message or distracting people?

A T-shirt with an eye-catching design or some provocative wording might be perfect for a night on the town, but if it's not supporting your message, it may be distracting and detracting from it. If in doubt, go neutral. Plainer clothes are often a good choice, or at least wear items of clothing that don't carry conflicting messaging.

—How will your audience be dressed?

Many suggest dressing slightly better than your audience helps establish some level of professionalism while also hanging on to some relatability. A key guideline is to never dress less formally than your audience.

—Are your clothes clean, ironed and in decent condition?

It's not suggested that you invest in a new wardrobe every time you need to make a public speech, but it's worth checking your clothes are neat and tidy enough not to distract people while you're talking. There's nothing worse than staring at a presenter with big square-shaped creases on his recently purchased shirt because he didn't allow time to iron it before taking the stage.

Sample Analysis

When you're presenting yourself, you might not notice your mistakes, but looking at a presenter from an audience's view, you can easily detect the bad habits of the presenter and avoid making the same mistakes in your own presentations.

In the video “*A Bad Presentation*”, the presenter is giving a terrible presentation. By studying the presentation, we can spot the bad habits that make it so ineffective and you should work hard to avoid when giving a presentation of your own.

Items	Mistakes
Content	• Not adding personal touches such as stories or opinions to captivate audience; • No self-introduction; • Not giving an outline of what the presenter is going to be talking about; • Few statements of the links between ideas or sections—lack of continuity between slides or sections; • Not using carefully chosen language and sentence structures; • Abrupt ending without closing statements tying up the central message neatly; • Not giving audience the chance to ask questions.
Design	• Heavily loaded slides without reflecting topic or theme; • Not using chart or table to display an amount of numbers.
Delivery	• Showing lack of dynamism, looking bored or disinterested; • Speaking in a flat monotonous tone; • Looking nervous; • Stiff posture—not moving naturally on stage; • Not well-prepared—unfamiliar with the content; • Few gestures to pass around and reinforce messages; • Avoiding eye contact—reading from the slides or computer; • Using inappropriate hand gestures—betraying lack of confidence and good preparation; • Talking to the screen with the back to the audience when looking at projected PowerPoint; • Reading what’s on slides word for word without giving any elaboration;

continued

Items	Mistakes
	• Not using expressive facial expression; • Mumbling occasionally; • Not speaking fluently and smoothly.

Tasks

1. Read the following characteristics of a good presentation. Put the numbers into the corresponding columns in the table.

What Makes a Good Presentation?		
Content	Design	Delivery

- 1) The presentation ideas are well adapted to the audience.
- 2) The presentation is concise and focused on the topic.
- 3) The presenter appears calm and relaxed while giving a presentation.
- 4) The presenter establishes eye contact with people in different locations.
- 5) The presenter uses a positive body language to convey messages well.
- 6) To communicate the desired information, the speaker uses more of visual aids such as diagrams, pictures, charts, etc.
- 7) Each slide contains limited and essential information only.

- 8) The presenter faces the audience, rather than the screen.
- 9) The presenter wants the presentation to be held at 10:00 in the morning in an airy, well-lighted room.
- 10) The presentation has a clear structure with a beginning, middle and end, and develops a logical progression from beginning to end.
- 11) The presenter rehearses and practices the presentation to be more confident and self-assured.
- 12) The presenter summarizes the presentation at the end, giving final comments and leaving a positive impact upon the audience.
- 13) The presenter has a presentable appearance while giving a presentation, standing with feet far apart maintaining a good balance, and using confident gestures.
- 14) The presenter tries to gain and maintain audience's interest by using humor.
- 15) The presenter states the objectives of the presentation at beginning.
- 16) The presenter uses examples to illustrate ideas.
- 17) The presenter uses bullet points rather than long sentences on slides.
- 18) The presenter checks frequently if the audience is still with him: "Does that make sense?", "Is that clear?".
- 19) The presenter speaks loudly, clearly and confidently.
- 20) The presenter takes his time, not rushing, pausing occasionally.
- 21) The presenter invites questions at the end of the presentation.
- 22) The presenter finishes within time limit.
- 23) The presenter moves purposefully around the stage during presentation.
- 24) The presenter is smartly dressed.
- 25) The presenter uses appropriate template that matches presentation objective and content.

2. Study the following examples of good and bad slides. Explain why they are effective or ineffective visual aids.

1)



Colors in presentations

- **not too colorful**
- many colors → not serious
- **emphasize important information**
- contrast background and font



Colors in presentations

- not too colorful
- many colors → not serious
- emphasize important information
- contrast background and font

2)



Too minimalistic design

- don't be too minimalistic
- don't use blank slides
- is boring
- looks lazy
- make it simple but serious



Too minimalistic design



- don't be too minimalistic
- don't use blank slides
- is boring
- looks lazy
- make it simple but serious

3)



Common mistakes in presentations

- In presentations you should not avoid eye contact with your audience
- You should never speak incoherently and you should not speak too fast. Avoid this by taking short pauses to collect yourself
- You should not use too many colors in your presentation because it doesn't look serious
- Avoid too many text on your presentation and never write entire sentences
- You should not use images as a background because the text will be difficult to read then
- You should speak free instead of reading aloud
- You should not read the text from the slides because your audience can read for themselves



Common mistakes in presentations

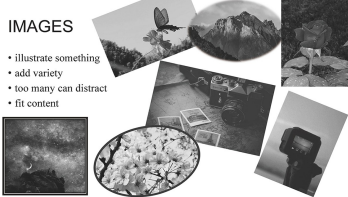
- Avoid eye contact
- Speaking incoherently
- Too many colors
- Too much text
- Images as background

4)



IMAGES

- illustrate something
- add variety
- too many can distract
- fit content




Images



- illustrate something
- add variety
- too many can distract
- fit content

5)



Fonts

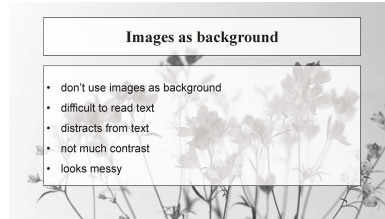
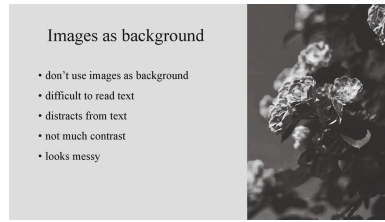
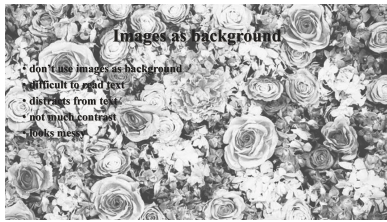
- many different fonts look messy
- **max. 2 different fonts**
- **LEGIBLE AT LONG DISTANCES**
- script, *italic* and decorative fonts → slow to read
- **should be avoided**



Fonts

- many different fonts look messy
- max. 2 different fonts
- legible at long distances
- script, italic and decorative fonts → slow to read
- should be avoided

6)



(Adapted from <https://slidelizard.com/en/blog/bad-presentations>)

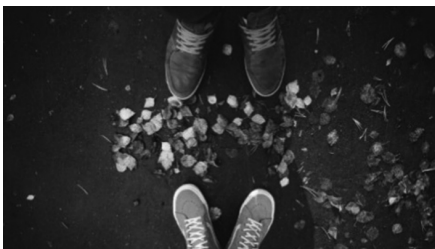
3. Can you read body language? Take the following body language quiz to find out:

1) What does this body language indicate?



- A. Shame.
- B. Sadness.
- C. Confidence.
- D. Nervousness.

2) True or false: When talking to someone, feet pointed towards you is a sign of mutual interest.



- A. True.
- B. False.

3) Which of the following eye movements indicates that a person is lying?



- A. Looking left.
- B. Looking right.
- C. Looking up.
- D. None of the above.

4) What does this body language cue indicate?



- A. Happiness.
- B. Fear.
- C. Confidence.
- D. Excitement.

5) Which of the following pictures best portrays the disgust emotion?



A



B



C



D

6) Is this a genuine smile?



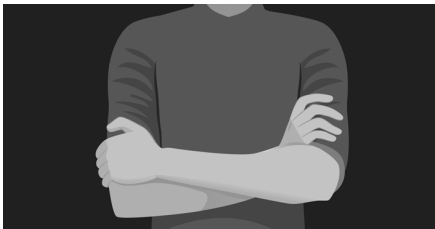
- A. Yes.
- B. No.

7) True or false: Putting objects in the mouth (such as pens, eyeglasses, fingernails) can be a sign of anxiety.



- A. True.
- B. False.

8) True or false: Crossed arms always indicate someone who is closed-off.



- A. True.
- B. False.

9) Which of the following body language cues from this picture indicate anger? (choose up to 5)



- A. Head tilted downwards.
- B. Eyebrows lowered.
- C. Eyes narrowed.
- D. Mouth to the side.
- E. Hands on hips.

10) Observe the following picture. What does their body language likely indicate?



- A. Frustration.
- B. Fear.
- C. Tiredness.
- D. Shame.
- E. All of the above.

(Adapted from <https://www.scienceofpeople.com/presentation-body-language/>)

4. Do you know the power of posing? In a TED Talk, the professional speaker Amy Cuddy shows that a power pose can help you establish authority. It's a great reminder that body language helps you come across as confident in your content. Do this before a presentation to boost your confidence, or do it during a presentation to command attention and feel powerful. Watch the video "Amy Cuddy: Your body language shapes who you are" and complete the following tasks.



- 1) Watch the video. Decide which of the following statements are true (T) or false (F).
 - a. The presenter asks the audience to change their postures at the very beginning of the speech to find comfortable postures for themselves. ()
 - b. Sometimes your body language can determine whether you will be employed or promoted. ()
 - c. People have given enough attention to how our nonverbals influence ourselves. ()
 - d. Only the primates express their power and dominance by expanding themselves. ()
 - e. The presenter notices that MBA students exhibit more power and dominance than the others when they come into the classroom. ()
 - f. Our nonverbals not only govern how other people but also how we think and feel about ourselves. ()

- g. When you pretend to be powerful, you are unlikely to actually feel powerful.
()
- h. It is revealed that high-power alpha males in primate hierarchies have low dominance hormones and high stress hormones. ()
- i. The findings of the first experiment reveal that our nonverbals do govern how the other people think and feel about ourselves. ()
- j. The second experiment aims to show that our bodies change our minds and our minds can change our behaviour, and our behaviour can change our outcomes.
()
- k. The purpose of the speech is to inform the audience of the presenter's research about body language. ()

2) Watch the talk again and match the captions A – F with the pictures a – g.

- A. Animals demonstrate power by making themselves big and stretching out.
- B. When athletes have won competitions, they show pride with their arms up in the V, and the chin slightly lifted.
- C. When we feel powerless, we make ourselves small.
- D. If someone is being really powerful with us, we tend to make ourselves smaller.
- E. This one is high-power pose.
- F. This one is low-power pose.



a. _____

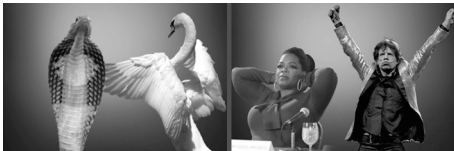
Unit 1 The Ingredients of a Great Presentation



b. _____



c. _____



d. _____



e. _____



f. _____



g. _____

CULTURAL NOTES

Be Aware of Cultural Differences in the Use of Gestures

Although certain presentation hand gestures and expressions fall under a universal language, gestures do not necessarily mean the same thing in every culture. For instance, your *OK* sign may mean just that, but to a person from another country, it might just be highly offensive.

Gestures are one of the first things to come to mind that can cause a major cultural faux pas. People from every culture, including country leaders, have been guilty of unintentionally offending people from different cultures through the use of inappropriate gestures.



In Brazil, Germany, Russia, and many other countries around the world, the *OK sign* is a very offensive gesture because it is used to depict a private bodily orifice. The *OK sign* actually does mean “okay” in the United States, however in Japan it means “money”, and it is commonly used to signify “zero” in France. Clearly the *OK sign* isn’t offensive everywhere; however, it is not OK to use in many parts of the world, nor does it necessarily mean “okay”!

Most people are aware that the *V for victory or peace sign* was made popular by Winston Churchill in England during WWII. However, it’s important to take heed of where you are in the world, because if you make this gesture with your *palm facing inward* in Australia, the United Kingdom, South Africa, and several other countries throughout the world, it in essence means “Up yours!”

The *thumbs-up gesture* is commonly used in many cultures to signify a job well done. However, if it is used in Australia, Greece, or the Middle East—especially if it is thrust up as a typical hitchhiking gesture would be—it means essentially “Up yours!” or “Sit on this!” The *thumbs-up gesture* can also create some real problems for those who count on their fingers. In Germany and Hungary, the *upright thumb* is used to represent the number 1; however, it represents the number 5 in Japan. There is a big difference between 1 and 5 million!

Professional speakers are all too aware that simply *pointing with the index finger* at something or someone can be offensive in many cultures. It is considered a very rude thing to do in China, Japan, Indonesia, Latin America, and many other countries. In Europe, it’s thought of as impolite, and in many African countries the index finger is used only for pointing at inanimate objects,

never at people. It's best to use an open hand with all your fingers together when you need to point at something or someone.

Curling the index finger with the palm facing up is a common gesture that people in the United States use to beckon someone to come closer. However, it is considered a rude gesture in Slovakia, East Asia, Malaysia, Singapore, the Philippines, and many other parts of the world. It's also considered extremely impolite to use this gesture with people. It is used only to beckon dogs in many Asian countries—and using it in the Philippines can actually get you arrested! The appropriate way to beckon someone in much of Europe, and parts of Asia, is to face the palm of your hand downward and move your fingers in a scratching motion.

The *open hand* or “*moutza*” gesture is insulting in parts of Africa and Asia, Greece, Pakistan, and in several other countries. It is formed by opening your palm with your fingers slightly apart and extending your arm toward someone, much like a wave in the U.S. This may seem harmless enough to many Westerners, however if someone does it with a more abrupt arm extension, its meaning changes to, “Enough is enough”, or “Let me stop you right there.” In other words, “Talk to the hand, because the face isn't listening!”

When it comes to body language gestures in the communication process, the important thing to keep in mind is that what we say, we say with our words, tonality, and body language.

Our body language often conveys more than the words we use. At times, it can completely change—or even nullify—our words' meaning.

Almost every gesture using fingers is sure to offend someone, somewhere, at some time. As a rule of thumb, it is best to avoid using any single finger as a gesture—unless you are absolutely sure it is appropriate for a particular culture or country. Open-handed gestures, with all fingers generally together, is usually considered the safest approach.

There are countless additional gestures that mean something different in every culture. Gestures have such a profound influence on communication that it really is the best to keep your fingers to yourself!

(Adapted from https://www.huffpost.com/entry/cross-cultural-gestures_b_3437653)

PROJECT

Work within a group of four. Analyze an academic presentation, a good example or a bad one, in terms of its **content** (objective, central message, introduction, closing, main points, organizational pattern, how to provide supporting details), **design** (visual aids), and **delivery** (non-verbal communication). Deliver a group presentation of around 15 minutes to the class.

CHECKLIST

☐	Understand content, design and delivery constitute a good presentation.
☐	Understand content involves key messages, supporting details, and how they are structured.
☐	Understand design mainly involves using visual aids.
☐	Understand delivery mainly involves using non-verbal communication.
☐	Grasp the basic guidelines for using PowerPoint slides effectively.
☐	Understand visual aids serve as a support for audience and presenter, not as a distraction.
☐	Identify common problems in designing PowerPoint slides.
☐	Recognize communication is achieved both verbally and non-verbally.
☐	Understand the importance of non-verbal language in presentation.
☐	Learn some ways to non-verbally support messages and project a strong image of a presenter, including eye contact, facial expressions, posture, gestures, and physical appearance.
☐	Learn how to evaluate strengths and weaknesses of a presentation.

Unit 2

Signposting Your Way Through a Presentation

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To understand the importance of presentation signposts;
- To identify different types of signposting;
- To use key signposts in a presentation.



SIGNPOSTING LANGUAGE

What Is Signposting Language?

When you are travelling on the road, there are signs which give you information. Some signs state the number of kilometers there are between you and your destination. Some signs warn you that there is some road work ahead and you will have to turn right to avoid it. Similarly, an effective way to make your presentation easy to follow is to use signposting language. No matter how you organize the body of your presentation, you must have clear transitions from section to section and point to point. Throughout a presentation, you will put up “signposts”, constantly telling the audience which section or point you have reached and where you are going now. This technique is called “signposting” during a presentation.

Signposting language in a presentation is verbal statements—usually words, phrases or sentences—that clearly highlight your key points and signal the logical connections between your ideas. In other words, signposting language guides your audience through the presentation, helping them understand how its content is structured, how many parts there are and/or what each part consists of. Signposting language is much more than just listing the order of ideas. It is more about telling the audience what you have done, what you are doing, and what you will do.

Why Do We Need Signposting Language in a Presentation?

While you are delivering what you think is an organized presentation, you know what you are saying and you can see clearly in your mind how your central idea is supported by different main points. However, your audience just hear the words and can’t envision how your presentation is structured. When the audience knows what subjects or sections are to come, they can listen to the information from the right perspective and know how to file the information away in the appropriate place in their minds. Once the audience doesn’t understand where you are going with your talk, they are likely to tune out. Unlike reading a text, your

audience can't flip backward or forward to figure out where you have been or where you are going when they are listening to you. Therefore, it is the presenter's responsibility to help the audience out with verbal signposting cues. If you don't use signposts to signal you're about to move on, your audience will most probably quickly lose track of where you are. If they're not sure where you are or whether you've moved on yet, they'll soon lose interest in what you are saying. Just as signposts are used on the roads to show you that your destination is 2 or 3 miles away from here, signposts in presentations are used to provide the audience with a sense of orientation. To summarize, signposting language is really important as it makes the organization of your presentation clearer to the audience and really helps the audience process the ideas that you're trying to pass across to them.

Types of Presentation Signposts

Even if you have invested plentiful hours preparing your presentation, you won't have an attentive audience if you don't guide them through the different stages in your presentation. When you are about to take up the next point after concluding one point, the audience must know you are moving to a new point, just like what a tour guide says "time to move on" to the visitors when they are through a particular area and want to visit a new place. It's of high importance that the audience are aware of this intention so that they can go along with you on the journey. Sometimes all through your presentation, there might be the need to continually refer to an earlier given example or story by reminding the audience about it in order to make your points well understood by the audience as you proceed with your speech. When you need to go into details on a point, you give the audience the signal of expansion or elaboration which will enable them to know there is more information coming on a particular topic, and that the speaker is still on the same topic but will be discussing it in more details. Also, it's often proper to go off on a tangent for a moment to express another crucial point that is loosely related to the main topic. Going off points during a presentation sometimes helps get or bring back the audience's attention. Sometimes you might

want to pass across an important message to the audience with “*This is really important, therefore, I am going to say it again ...*” The use of repetition is to attract audience’s attention to a key message as well as to give it more emphasis. In giving a speech, you’re creating some points, elaborating these points, and then summarizing these very points in the end. Summarizing a speech gives the audience a better understanding of what you have conveyed to them in a nutshell. When rounding up a speech, it is of significance to call the audience’s attention for the last time so that they can pick up some things they might have missed during the main speech.

Sample Analysis

You’re going to listen to an extract from a presentation on genetically modified (GM) food. Listen to the speech for the first time and consider the following questions. 

- What’s about GM food the speaker is mainly talking about?
- How many viewpoints about GM food is the speaker presenting?

Now the speaker has modified his presentation by adding some connectives. Listen again and compare the two versions to see which one makes the presentation easy to follow. 

The speaker is talking about the benefits of GM foodstuffs. He is presenting four arguments supporting GM food. Obviously, the second version makes the sections and the ideas of the presentation very clear and easy to follow because the speaker uses signposting language, or words and phrases that connect the different sections and ideas of a speech and indicate the relationship between them. It’s important to note how the speaker uses signposting language to keep the audience’s attention and navigate them through the speech—letting the audience know that he has just finished one section and is starting another section, he is referring forward, he is introducing a subject, and he is sequencing information.

Presentation	Commentary
Well, now, we've seen some examples of existing, or proposed, or possible genetically modified food, or GM foodstuffs. Now we turn to consider arguments for GM food and then against the use of GM food. For this is one of the most contentious issues in the world today. I'll just repeat this. I'm suggesting it's one of the most contentious issues in the world today. Let's just look at some of the arguments for GM foodstuffs. The first is that productivity can be increased through genetic engineering so that more food can be produced more cheaply to meet the demands of the increasing human population. The second argument is that a number of genetically improved plants include extra nutrients	• At the beginning of this part of presentation, the presenter says “<i>Well, now, we've seen some examples of existing, or proposed, or possible genetically modified food, or GM foodstuffs</i>” to indicate that he has finished one section. Then he switches to another section by immediately saying “<i>Now we turn to consider arguments for GM food and then against the use of GM food.</i>” • The presenter tells his audience that GM food has aroused worldwide controversy and he wants to highlight this point by repetition. By signaling “<i>I'll just repeat this</i>” he is calling the audience's attention. He continues to introduce a subject, the arguments for GM foodstuffs, by saying “<i>Let's just look at some of the arguments for GM foodstuffs.</i>” • After that, he enumerates four benefits for the use of GM foods by saying “<i>The first is that ... The second argument is that ... A third argument now in favor of GM foods is that ... Lastly, ...</i>”

continued

Presentation	Commentary
or fewer harmful substances, like rice with added vitamin E and iron, potatoes that produce fewer cancer-causing chemicals when fried, and cooking oils with reduced amounts of saturated fats and increased essential amino acids. A third argument now in favor of GM foods is that genetic engineering has allowed farmers to grow crops in harsh conditions that were previously unsuitable for these crops. Lastly, genetic engineering is used to make new fruits and vegetables that can be brought to market in good condition and have a longer shelf life. Well, so much for a summary of some of the arguments for the use of GM foods. Now, let's turn next to some arguments against the use of such foods. First, there is a widespread fear that...	• The same signaling technique with the beginning of the presentation is found at the end. He tells us he is done talking about the arguments supporting the use of GM foods, and that he will now talk about the opposing ideas. He says “<i>Well, so much for a summary of some of the arguments for the use of GM foods,</i>” which is immediately followed by “<i>Now, let's turn next to some arguments against the use of such foods</i>” to signal that he has finished one section and is starting another one.

Tasks

Read the following presentation signposts and indicate why the speaker says so.

1) As you can see, I'm here today to talk to you about cyber violence.

2) We've discussed how to recognize stage fright. That brings us to my next topic, how to overcome it.

3) So just how serious is the problem of internet fraud? Is it a few isolated cases, or is it wide-spread enough to require serious countermeasures to protect consumers?

4) May I focus your attention on the statistics in this table?

5) Don't worry if this isn't so clear now, I'll explain the details later.

6) I have broken my speech down into three parts.

7) We cannot ignore the problems that such an action would bring about.

8) Just to repeat what I said earlier, the proportion of female students majoring in engineering is decreasing.

- 9) Well, that's all from me today. It's been a great pleasure to share this with you today.
-
-

- 10) Going off on a tangent, I believe it is important to say a few words about their family backgrounds.
-
-

CULTURAL NOTES

In both essays and presentations, signposting is a surefire way to help readers or audience understand your point or the connection between points, and ensure that they don't get lost through your essay or presentation. Single words and short phrases can be useful signposts in both essays and presentations. For example, *however* is used to pivot to an opposing idea or to acknowledge another side of an argument; *consequently* indicates that an idea is a result or consequence of a previously discussed idea or point; and *first*, *next*, *then*, *finally*, or *first*, *second*, *third*, *last but not least* identify the sequence or direction of your argument.

However, it is crucial to understand that signposting in writing and speaking styles are not all the same. Here are some examples of helpful signposts in a writing:

- “*This essay examines biblical symbolism in Moby-Dick ...*” This signpost states the focus of the essay.
- “*After a review of recent scholarship on biblical symbolism, I consider how Melville relates funerary symbolism to both death and rebirth ...*” This signpost clarifies how the author's focus is distinguished from previous scholarship.
- “*My purpose in focusing on Queequeg's coffin ...*” This signpost clarifies the stakes of the author's argument.

Using signposts can improve your writing by giving it structure and direction, but if you use in your writing the signposts that are comfortably used

in a presentation, you are taking a risk of creating unnecessary wordiness, and can give the impression that you don't trust the reader's ability to follow your argument or that you're grafting signposts on to compensate for a poorly articulated argument. Here are some signposts that are often heard in a presentation but may do more harm than good in a writing:

Signpost	Commentary
<i>It's important to note that</i> Melville's treatment ...	• Show, don't tell, what is important.
<i>What I want to call attention to in this passage ...</i>	• Skip the wordy opening; lead with "In this passage ..."
<i>I will now turn to</i> the pulpit of Father Mapple ...	• If you've signposted your essay's structure at its beginning, you don't have to give directions throughout.
<i>As I argued in the previous section,</i> the symbolism of the white whale ...	• If the point has been well made, your reader will remember it. Summarize it briefly, but you don't need to mention the earlier section.

(Adapted from <https://style.mla.org/effective-signposting/>)

LANGUAGE FOCUS

To compel your audience to keep listening and satisfy their insatiable desire—"I want to know where I am in your presentation at all times"—it is a good idea to learn different types of signposts that you can embed in your presentations. The following are some of the key signpost expressions in presentations that guide you on the overall topic and content of the presentation, and when different sections or points are being discussed.

Useful Expressions

- **Introducing the topic of the lecture**

- 1) Today I'll be talking about/discussing ...
- 2) The subject/topic of today's lecture is ...
- 3) This morning we are going to take a look at ...
- 4) The purpose of today's lecture is ...

- **Introducing the first section/subtopic or first of a list of points**

- 1) I'll begin with/start with ...
- 2) Let's start by talking about ...
- 3) To begin, ...
- 4) The first advantage/reason/cause/etc. is ...

- **Finishing one subject and moving on to another subject**

- 1) That's all I would like to say about ..., and now let us turn to ...
- 2) So, that was my first point. Now I'm going to move on to my second point ...
- 3) Now that we've seen ..., let's examine more closely.
- 4) Now that we've had a clear understanding of ..., let me share ... with you.
- 5) So much for ..., let's take a moment to look at a few other reports.
- 6) Keeping these points in mind, let's turn to ...
- 7) We've spoken so far of ... Well, what is the significance of this?

- **Explaining structure (sections/subtopics)**

- 1) I've divided my presentation into two/three/four parts.
- 2) First we'll look at ... Then we'll go on to ... And finally I'll ...
- 3) In today's lecture I'm going to cover three points.
- 4) First, I'll explain X and then I'll move onto talk about ...
- 5) Basically/Briefly, I have three things to say.

- **Referring backwards and forwards**

- 1) You'll remember I said ...
- 2) As I mentioned earlier ...
- 3) Can I come back to this point?
- 4) To repeat what I've said so far ...
- 5) Do you remember I said ...?
- 6) I'll talk more about this later.

- 7) More on this later on.
- 8) The details will come later.

• **Highlighting points**

- 1) It's important to remember that ...
- 2) This is important/significant because ...
- 3) You're probably thinking that... and you're right/but this would be a mistake ...
- 4) Please notice that ...
- 5) Note this point: ...
- 6) Why is this important?
- 7) The point I'm trying to make here is ...
- 8) Recapping on the previous point I made about ...
- 9) Let me repeat that ...

• **Going into more details on a point**

- 1) Let me talk more in-depth about ...
- 2) By focusing on ... in detail, ...
- 3) To be more precise ...
- 4) Expanding on that point ...
- 5) I'd like to expand on/elaborate on this point.

• **Referring to visuals**

- 1) Now let's look at the table/chart/diagram.
- 2) You'll notice that ...
- 3) OK, so you can see a summary of our results here ...
- 4) You can see the features well in this picture.
- 5) Looking at the slide/chart/graph you can see ...
- 6) To illustrate this, let's have a closer look at ...

• **Paraphrasing and clarifying**

- 1) Simply put, ...
- 2) In other words, ...
- 3) So what I'm saying is ...
- 4) To put it more simply, ...
- 5) To put it another way, ...

- **Sequencing information**

- 1) Firstly ... secondly ... thirdly ... lastly ...
- 2) To start with ... later ... to finish up ...
- 3) I'll begin/start off by ... Then I'll move onto ... Next/After that ... I'll end by ...

- **Talking off-topic for a moment**

- 1) I'd like to digress here for a moment and just say a few words of thanks to Mr. X for organizing this meeting.
- 2) As a side note ...
- 3) Let me deviate ...
- 4) If I could just digress for a second, ...

- **Summarizing and concluding**

- 1) To sum up/summarize ...
- 2) Right, let's sum up, shall we?
- 3) Let's summarize briefly what we've looked at ...
- 4) Before I leave the stage, I want to leave you with this.
- 5) If I can just sum up the main points ...
- 6) Finally, let me remind you of some of the issues we've covered.
- 7) To conclude/In conclusion/In short/In closing, let me say ...
- 8) So, to remind you of what I've covered in this talk, ...
- 9) Unfortunately, I seem to have run out of time, so I'll conclude very briefly by saying that ...
- 10) I'd like now to recap ...
- 11) As I conclude .../To close this off ...
- 12) From this, it could be concluded that ...

- **Finishing up**

- 1) I hope my rather rapid explanation was clear.
- 2) Thank you very much for your attention/listening.
- 3) Well, that's all from me today. It's been a great pleasure to share this with you today. Thank you very much.

Tasks

Translate the following sentences into English.

1) 首先我要对本领域近几年的研究工作做一个简要的回顾。

2) 我的演讲将由以下四个部分构成:第一部分对目前这项研究做一个简要的背景介绍,第二部分是关于研究方法的介绍,第三部分主要分析研究结果,最后一部分讨论的是结论和此项研究有待改进之处。

3) 今天我想跟大家简单探讨有关大学英语教学的问题。我谈一下我的看法,也算是抛砖引玉。

4) 文献综述我就介绍到这里,下面我想谈一下这个项目的可行性。

5) 这是我今天所讲内容中最重要的一个部分,所以我会提供更多细节对此加以重点说明。

6) 由于时间有限,我只能简单罗列我一直从事的研究。对你们所提出的任何问题我愿意随时和你们展开讨论。

PROJECT

You will hear an academic presentation on the topic of the Caveman diet. Work with a partner and follow the steps given below.

Step 1 Before you listen, go through the words and phrases related to the topic in the vocabulary box.

macrobiotic <i>adj.</i> 健康养生的	Paleo or Caveman diet 原始人饮食法
forebear <i>n.</i> 祖先	legume <i>n.</i> 豆类作物
come to the fore 进入前列;引人注目	forage <i>vi.</i> 寻觅, 搜寻
plantain <i>n.</i> 车前草	yam <i>n.</i> 山药
lactose <i>n.</i> 乳糖	enzyme lactase 乳糖分解酶
lactose intolerance 乳糖不耐受	saliva <i>n.</i> 唾液
homogenous <i>adj.</i> 同种类的	

Step 2 Listen to the presentation for the first time and answer the following questions to catch the main ideas of the presentation. 

- 1) What is the speaker mainly talking about?
 - A. The Atkins diet.
 - B. The South Beach diet.
 - C. The Paleo diet.
 - D. The macrobiotic plan.
- 2) Which of the following arguments is TRUE of the proponents of the Caveman diet?
 - A. The bodies of modern people are well suited to digest complex carbohydrates.
 - B. We should eat like our ancient ancestors.
 - C. Our bodies are not well suited to digest meat, fish, nuts and berries.
 - D. Wheat, oats or other grains are more healthful than meat and fish.
- 3) What is the speaker's attitude toward the Caveman diet?
 - A. Positive.
 - B. Negative.
 - C. Neutral.
 - D. Not known.
- 4) What does the speaker think of the human digestive system?
 - A. We are unable to make modifications to our digestive systems according to the foods available in our local environment.
 - B. Many examples illustrate that the human digestive system is suited to digesting only a few foods.

- C. Many examples illustrate that the human digestive system cannot change to accommodate different food sources.
- D. The human digestive system is highly adaptive to digest what foods are available in our local environment.
- 5) The speaker doesn't agree with following the Caveman diet for _____ reasons.
- A. two. B. three. C. four. D. five.

Step 3 Listen again until you complete the table with the signposting language the speaker uses and the purpose of the signposting. 🎧

Purpose	Signposting language
Introducing the topic of the presentation	1) _____
Introducing the first subtopic	2) _____
3) _____	..., that is, ...
4) _____	Sounds logical, doesn't it? But, let's look a little closer.
Highlighting a point	5) _____
6) _____	• One way to discover this is to ... • So, what do they eat when they can't get meat? • So, if we can eat a variety of diets, is there anything actually wrong with following the Caveman diet?
Giving an example	7) _____ 8) _____ 9) _____

continued

Purpose	Signposting language
10) _____	• ... and evidence suggests that ... • Researchers suggest that ... • Research shows that ... • In fact, the evidence would suggest exactly the opposite.
Sequencing information	11) _____

Step 4 Discuss with your partner how the signposting language in this presentation can facilitate and reinforce your understanding of the presentation.

CHECKLIST

☐	Understand the importance of signposting in a presentation.
☐	Identify different types of signposting in a presentation.
☐	Master some useful signaling language.

Unit 3

The Basics of International Conferences

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To recognize the importance of attending international conferences;
- To learn about how to find conferences to attend;
- To be acquainted with the formats of conference sessions;
- To understand how a conference is organized, figure out who is responsible for what, and know what a typical conference timeline is like.



NAVIGATING INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCES

The Benefits of Attending International Conferences

An international conference is a formal meeting attended by people from around the world, usually lasting one to five days and covering a relatively wide range of research topics. It provides a professional platform for both junior and senior researchers to share the latest developments and exchange innovative ideas in their research fields. Students, researchers, practitioners, and policy-makers are welcome to present knowledge, ideas, and insights, contributing to a healthy and sustainable learning ambiance. Attending international conferences could benefit various aspects of one's academic life, especially for postgraduate students and early-career researchers.

As an international conference attracts a worldwide audience, including well-renowned experts, it is a perfect place to test whether the quality of your research stands the scrutiny from the outside world and, hopefully, get valuable feedback on your research through discussing your work with peers. The audience may rise constructive and out-of-the-box questions. Discussion on some of these questions at conferences could even be further developed into interesting text in your thesis or dissertation. Some questions might help identify areas in need of clarification. Moreover, you might get literature recommendations from other attendees that would help deepen your understanding of your research topics. Apart from questions and literature recommendations, you are also likely to receive criticism. This is actually a gift in disguise because it would either help you improve your research methods if condition permits, or help you anticipate critical comments from reviewers before submitting your manuscript to a thesis committee or an academic journal.

Most of the research presented at international conferences has not been published yet but was selected on merits by advisory committees. This means conference participants are privileged with early access to new ideas, opinions, and works of excellent researchers long before their findings get published in professional journals. These new ideas and concepts obtained through international

conferences could enrich your future research, and the knowledge and skills acquired at international conferences could enhance your academic competitiveness. Therefore, attending conferences helps participants to keep up with the latest progress in their research fields and stay a step ahead of their non-participating peers.

Cooperation and network relations affect the path of academic careers considerably. As a matter of fact, it takes more than diligence to make it to the top of the career ladder in academia. Being well-connected and collaborating on research increase the chances of achieving academic excellence. International conferences connect scientists and researchers from different parts of the world and facilitate learning through shared areas of interest, offering great opportunities to utilize your networking skills and establish new connections that might be useful in the future. Furthermore, attending international conferences not only encourages interaction among researchers of similar interests but also promotes multidisciplinary collaboration among researchers from different fields.

An international conference participation certificate is like a cherry on top of your CV. However, many postgraduate students do not attach much importance to attending conferences for fear that it would slow down the writing of their theses/dissertations. Although it is not mandatory that a postgraduate student should attend international conferences, having such experiences is a respectable accomplishment. Therefore, even though writing up conference abstracts/papers and attending conferences indeed require considerable time and effort, it is worthwhile to invest in conference participation for it helps you stand out in academic job applications.

Additionally, if you're attending an international conference, you will be able to visit a foreign country and explore its local culture, which is a non-academic perk. You can even take a mini-vacation after the conference if you really love the place and would like to spend a little more time there.

In conclusion, attending conferences allows you to present your latest findings, join discussions, and network with peers, which is likely to enrich your research and career and facilitate continuous learning. Don't miss out on these opportunities!

How to Find Academic Conferences

Now that you have known the benefits of attending conferences, would you like to go to a conference yourself? If so, you need to discover conferences of your research interests first. It is not easy, however, to find the ones that are just right for you with millions of academic conferences out there. Here are some sources of information for finding academic conferences.

- **Internet search engines**

When you are looking for academic conferences to attend, it is advisable to start with internet search engines (e.g., Baidu and Bing), which systematically search the World Wide Web for relevant information as specified in a web search query. The search results, usually containing tremendous amounts of data, are presented as lines of search engine results. As it is impossible to go through all the results, the presentation order of the result set matters. All major search engines employ their own methods/algorithms, aiming to rank results in a way that the most relevant, popular, and authoritative ones are displayed first. Therefore, you are recommended to use multiple search engines to avoid leaving out highly-relevant results.

- **Conference alert platforms**

Conference alert platforms help stay up to date on all events in your field. You can search and browse conference announcement directories for academic conferences, workshops, seminars, and other programs that you take interest in. For example, <https://conferencealerts.com/> is a website that lists upcoming conferences by country and topic. By browsing such websites, you can get a picture of the international conferences in your academic field. After identifying conferences of interest, subscribe to personalized conference alerts to keep track of newly-announced events. Similarly, it is also possible to subscribe to a discipline listserv (i.e., electronic mailing list) for conference updates and calls for proposals.

- **Journals and magazines**

Key academic conferences tend to advertise in academic journals and magazines so as to reach their target researchers directly. It's desirable to look for conference announcements in the latest issues of high-impact journals relevant to

your research topics. Note that, as publishing takes time, it may take weeks or months before the conference announcements get to subscribers, making it harder for them to meet submission deadlines. Nevertheless, regularly checking what conferences are advertised in academic journals is a great way to keep track of the most influential academic events in your field.

- **Consulting your supervisors and fellow researchers**

Ask your supervisors and fellow researchers what local, national, and international conferences they've attended and how beneficial they consider those events. Sometimes conference organizers reach out to the heads of academic departments, so don't hesitate to reach out to your own department or contact your local university and ask them which conferences they recommend. These word-of-mouth recommendations will help you identify which conferences in your field are worth considering. By the way, once you have found specific academic conferences that appeal to you, remember to subscribe to their newsletter so that you will not miss any important information about these conferences.

Finally, when looking for a conference to attend, you need to learn to identify and avoid predatory conferences. Early-career researchers eager to improve their resume/CV sometimes may fall victim to revenue-seeking companies that hold poorly-organized and profit-fueled conferences. These “predatory conferences” are not organized by scholarly or professional societies and do not use a peer-review system. They often have high acceptance rates and charge excessive fees to attend. Predatory conferences usually falsely claim that certain researchers sit on their organizing committees. Attending a predatory conference can be a costly mistake for your research and budget.

The Formats of Conference Sessions

After deciding on which conference you would like to attend, the next step is to get to know what sessions this conference is composed of. Special attention should be paid to the formats of the conference sessions. Note that conference session formats may vary depending on the size and scope of the conference and whether it is held online or offline. Nevertheless, the purpose of these different

session formats is always to maximize interactions and exchanges among organizers, presenters/authors, and the audience.

Even though conference session formats take various names, they can be roughly classified into keynote sessions, oral sessions, poster sessions, and research-in-progress sessions (excluding opening and closing ceremonies).

- **Keynote sessions**

A keynote session consists of one or multiple invited lectures or keynote presentations by well-known experts in a research field. Keynote speeches serve the function of setting the tone for the theme of the conference and are of universal significance and general interests for all the participants. Therefore, keynote talks are, most often than not, delivered to the entire conference group at plenary sessions, and papers presented therein are usually included as full-length papers in conference literature.

- **Oral sessions**

Oral session, sometimes called paper session, forms a contrast with poster session(see below). In general, abstracts or full-length papers that have gone through peer review and received relatively high scores would be presented orally, while those that have passed peer review with relatively low scores would be presented as posters. The category of oral sessions can be further divided into individual paper sessions and colloquium/colloquia sessions depending on whether the papers in a session have been accepted independently from each other or accepted simultaneously under the umbrella of a pre-selected topic. Oral sessions may be organized as plenary sessions, panel sessions or concurrent sessions. Papers presented at oral sessions form the main part of conference pre-prints or proceedings.

- **Poster sessions**

Different from presentations in oral sessions, which are usually delivered orally with the aid of slides, papers presented in poster sessions are displayed as posters posted on boards or walls in a specially separated area of a conference venue. Conference participants can go there, read the posters, and have a brief discussion with the authors. Note that sometimes contributions submitted as an oral presentation may be accepted as a poster due to the limited amount of time

slots available for oral presentation. Nevertheless, poster sessions provide an opportunity to engage with other conference participants sharing similar research interests, allowing for longer and more in-depth discussions than oral sessions. You might strike up a conversation with someone about your poster that leads to future collaboration.

- **Research-in-progress sessions**

Research-in-progress sessions are intended to be a place to discuss new research, projects, or current work in progress in a comfortable and enriching learning environment. Papers or abstracts submitted for research-in-progress sessions are usually short, sketching an ongoing research project or study. Discussions typically involve a chairperson and several presenters.

- **Symposia**

Symposia consist of a small group of presenters who share differing ideas related to a common theme and discuss them with the audience. Symposia and panel discussions are similar in many ways. Note that a symposium often consists of scholarly research conducted independently by the different presenters, whereas a panel discussion frequently is a forum for research or expertise that panelists have gained over time. Unlike other concurrent sessions, which are organized by conference organizers or section chairs, symposia/panels are organized by the presenters. They assume responsibility for proposing a topic that aligns with the theme of the conference, identifying presenters, describing the format to be used during the session, and putting the proposal together.

How Is a Conference Organized?

This section invites you to look at international conferences from the perspective of conference organizers rather than that of conference participants. It demonstrates the key practical considerations of organizing academic conferences. Although planning and running an international conference requires substantial time and effort, it is an immensely rewarding experience that can help further establish yourself in your research field and foster valuable associations with your peers.

You would need to look at external and internal funding you could get

through sponsorship, through your department, or from other research institutions. Reach out to your academic peers who have organized conferences in the past and get advice from them on funding and logistics. Don't rush this process, get involved in discussions on organizing research conferences, take your time and get as much experience as you can before you run the research conference.

After having decided to organize a conference, you should start planning the conference at least half a year prior to the conference dates. The first thing is to get your committee on board. Every successful research conference needs an active organizing committee. No matter whether it is a large-scale committee or a few dedicated members, everyone should have clear responsibilities.

- **Organizers and sponsors**

Conference organizers are persons or institutions that organize the conference. Its main responsibilities include managing the event, deciding the theme(s) to be presented, selecting a venue, inviting guest speakers, sending out invitations to interested parties, and appointing a chair of the organizing committee and the required staff to carry out the event. Conference sponsors, on the other hand, are the institutions overseeing the financial, technical, publicity, and administrative running of the conference. Conference sponsorship may take different forms, but the most common one is financial support.

- **Organizing committee**

A proactive organizing committee is at the core of every successful academic conference, making all major decisions and taking overall responsibility for the success of the conference. The organizing committee of a small-scale conference may only have 2 to 3 members, while that of a large-scale conference can involve hundreds of people, including the chairperson, vice-chairperson, secretary-general, deputy secretary-general, technical staff, and other committee members. Each member has their specific duties and is responsible to the sponsors and the organizers.

- **Academic committee**

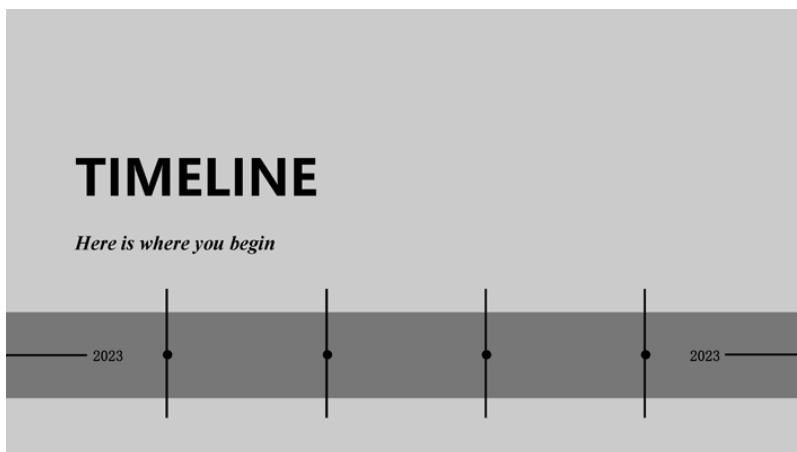
Academic committee, also known as “advisory committee”, “scientific committee” or “paper committee”, oversees all academic activities of a conference. Its main responsibilities are to collect and evaluate submissions, design agendas,

arrange academic communication in and out of the conference, and prepare conference facilities. The academic committee is also responsible for the publication of conference proceedings wherever applicable.

- **Secretary**

The secretary is responsible for keeping and distributing meeting minutes, circulating the conference program, receiving and responding to inquiries, handling complaints, publishing preprints and proceedings, and so on. The secretary is the first person a participant should try to contact whenever a problem occurs. The contact information of the secretary can be found in all publicity of a conference.

A Typical Conference Timeline



1. Decide on the theme of the conference
2. Get your committee on board
3. Secure the conference venue
4. Launch a conference website
5. Make a conference budget
6. Invite keynote speakers
7. Open submissions
8. Issue your Call for Papers

9. Invite reviewers
10. Close submission and begin review
11. Open registration
12. Closer eview and send letters of acceptance
13. Design your conference schedule , publish your final program , and print book of proceedings
14. Hold your conference
15. Write post-conference report

Note that these steps aren't strictly chronological.

Tasks

- 1. Please summarize the benefits of attending international conferences mentioned in the above article. Can you think of other possible benefits not mentioned above?**

- 2. Discover top international conferences in your academic field and decide on which one you would like to attend the most. Then describe how you have found this conference and explain the reasons for your choice.**

- 3. Can you think of other sources or methods to discover academic conferences in your field? Discuss with your team members and come up with a list.**

4. Match the session formats with their corresponding descriptions.

Symposia	Roundtable Discussions
Pre-conference Workshops	Hands-On Presentations
Traditional Presentations	Posters
Bright Spots	E-posters

- 1) Technical specification for _____: 1920 pixels by 1080 pixels (an aspect ratio of 16:9), save it either as a .jpg or .jpeg file at 100 ppi (pixels per inch) Display time: 3 minutes and 2 minutes for Q&A.
- 2) _____ are succinct talks that celebrate specific triumphs and showcase things that work. These 10-minute presentations highlight successful and innovative family programs, school programs, community partnerships, conservation achievements, expanded audiences, research findings, civic engagement, and more. (10 minutes)
- 3) _____ are designed to engage participants in virtual teaching activities, interactive discussions, and more. Hands-on sessions may be offered as live or pre-recorded on-demand sessions. (60 minutes)
- 4) _____ are large printed sheets that summarize programs, resources, research studies, or other work through text, images, and data. They are most often created using applications such as Adobe InDesign, Adobe Illustrator, Microsoft Publisher, Microsoft PowerPoint, and others. Presenters may include an optional pre-recorded introduction up to three minutes in length. (3-minute option)
- 5) _____ emphasize spirited discussion about a central question between the presenter(s) and session attendees. Presenters briefly introduce the baseline idea or question they wish to explore and then open the discussion to exchange ideas. (40 minutes)
- 6) _____ are organized as part of the international conference to provide a platform for in-depth exploration and discussion of specific areas within the broader field of study. Proposals must include a moderator and a minimum of three panelists representing different organizations, ideas, or experiences. (60 minutes)
- 7) _____ focus on a single topic or program, typically including a talk or

PowerPoint (or other media) presentation followed by questions and answers or a short discussion. (30 minutes)

- 8) _____ are in-depth sessions that actively develop specific professional competencies and have widespread potential for implementation. They are offered prior to a conference and may require a separate registration fee. (3½ hours)

5. Take a look at the website of your previously-chosen conference and find out who are the organizers, sponsors, members of the organizing committee and the advisory committee, and keynote speakers.

CULTURAL NOTES

Since its outbreak in early 2020, the COVID-19 pandemic has had widespread impact on the international meetings industry, including academic conference. On the one hand, meeting industry has suffered a crippling blow. On the other hand, this pandemic brings out quite a few novel virtual conference session formats. Read the following “Menu” of virtual session formats adopted in an international conference and then make a comparison between traditional conference session formats with these virtual session formats.

- **Standard Presentation Session** (Possible in Zoom Webinar mode)

The session should be focused on an innovative, challenging theme or question. One to four presenters are given approximately 15 minutes each to present material related to the theme of the session. Following the presentations, the session convener then facilitates a question-and-answer session between speakers and the audience using the Q&A function on Zoom. Variations could include pre-recording the presentations, and/or using a more interactive discussion format instead of a Q&A—i.e., using the Whiteboard function in Zoom or Miro board or Google Jamboard to gather inputs from the participants on a set of questions.



- **7-14-28 Presentation Session** (Possible in Zoom Webinar mode)

7-14-28 presentation is a rapid-fire showcase of ideas, innovations, and theories. Speakers have a 7-minute time limit for their talk utilizing a deck of no more than 14 slides that have a minimum 28-point font size for any text. 7-14-28 allows speakers to focus on the essentials of their subject, while offering an audience the chance to enjoy multiple presentations in one sitting. Following the presentations the session convener should then facilitate a Q&A session between speakers and the audience using the Q&A function on Zoom. Variations could include pre-recording the presentations, and/or using a more interactive discussion format instead of a Q&A—i.e. using the Whiteboard function in Zoom or Google Jamboard to gather inputs from the participants on a set of questions.

- **Panel Session** (Possible in Zoom Webinar mode)

Panel sessions are a great way to get more than one expert opinion on a topic in a short amount of time. Panels consist of three-to-five people with preferably contradictory opinions discussing a specific topic in a conversation moderated by a session chair. The session should be framed around a clear question, which is introduced by the chair. Each panel member then has 3 to 5 minutes to give a position statement introducing their opinions. The chair should

then facilitate a Q&A session among the panel members (max 1/3 of the session time) before inviting questions from the audience using the Q&A function on Zoom.

- **Fishbowl Session** (Possible in Zoom Webinar mode)

Four to five participants are pre-selected to be the first active participants of the “inner circle”. This is the fishbowl. They will have their cameras active during the best part of the session. The remaining session participants will have their cameras turned off—they are “outside the fishbowl”. The moderator introduces the topic and the participants inside the fishbowl start discussing the topic. The audience outside the fishbowl listens in on the discussion. Any member of the audience can, at any time, request to join the fishbowl, replacing one of the existing members. Those who want to join send a request to the moderator including a comment who they want to replace. The moderator has to smoothly transition this shift, with the exiting member turning off their camera, and the incoming member turning theirs on. The discussion continues with participants entering and leaving the fishbowl. Depending on how large the audience is you can have many audience members spend some time in the fishbowl and take part in the discussion. When time runs out, the fishbowl is closed and the moderator summarizes the discussion. The challenge for the speakers is to speak in a way that leaves space for non-speakers to join in. During the majority of the discussions, there are many others in the circle who are not visible. It is therefore helpful to make everyone aware of who is present, i.e., spend a few minutes in the beginning asking everyone to turn their cameras on, having a brief check in to just see all the people who are in the session.

- **Campfire Session** (Possible in Zoom normal mode with minor changes)

Campfire Sessions begin a lot like a traditional presentation, with a speaker (or multiple speakers) at the presenting an idea to a group of people. After 15 or 20 minutes, however, the focus shifts from the presenter to the audience. The goal is the creation of an open forum in which the attendees generate the majority of the discussion and knowledge sharing. For the remainder of the session, the presenter becomes a facilitator, inviting responses to comments and questions from those around the room and letting the audience dictate the ultimate direction

of the conversation. Campfire sessions allow attendees to drive their own learning, listen to multiple perspectives on the same issue, and share experiences with individuals throughout the room. Campfire sessions also lend themselves to networking. In order to create the space for this kind of conversation online, it is helpful to start the session with a few minutes of breakout groups and also insert some breakout elements in between—sending small groups of 3 to 5 people off for 5 to 10 minutes to discuss a specific issue, then bringing their ideas back to the plenary—depending on how many people are participating.

- **World Café Session** (Possible in Zoom normal mode combined with a Miro board or similar for harvesting notes from the breakout “tables” or “rooms”)

The World Café is a format designed to encourage a flow of conversation between participants, facilitate broad audience participation, and enable a more sustained discussion. Attendees are assigned to online “tables” or breakout “rooms” with four-to-six participants. The process begins with a brief introduction and a “big” question, which attendees are asked to discuss (generally for about 15 minutes). Participants use Miro board or a similar whiteboard function to capture their discussions. Once time is up, all-but-one of the participants from each “room” move to a different group and repeat the process. The person who stays functions as a “table/room host” and reviews what was discussed during the previous rounds. Following two to three rounds of discussions, key points from each “room” are presented (i.e., while sharing Miro board) to the whole group for a final collective discussion.

- **Speed Geeking Session** (Possible with Zoom or Wonder-Me. The former is more structured, the latter more free-flowing)

A set of “active experts” is pre-selected, and a brief of their “expertise” shared in advance of the session. The remaining members of the session are geeks who want to learn from these experts. Ideally there are about 6 to 7 participants to each “active expert”. One person acts as the facilitator.

In Zoom, the session proceeds as follows: The audience is split up into breakout groups and each group is assigned to one of the “active experts”. The experts have 5 minutes to introduce their work and answer questions. At the end of the five minutes, the facilitator shifts the breakout group members into a room

with the next “expert”. The session ends when every group has visited each “expert”. With Wonder-Me, each expert sets up a “circle” and the participants of the session can “wonder” from circle to circle freely.

- **Open Space Session** (Possible with Wonder-Me/also possible with Zoom normal mode, involves some more prep effort, sign-up sheets)

The approach is most distinctive for its initial lack of an agenda, which sets the stage for the session’s participants to create the agenda for themselves. Typically, an “open space” session will begin with short introductions by a single facilitator of the general theme of the session and the “self-organizing” process called “open space”. Then the group creates the working agenda, as individuals post their topics on an electronic bulletin board/whiteboard (i.e., Miro, Zoom whiteboard, Google Jamboard). Each individual “convener” of a breakout group takes responsibility for naming the topic, posting it on the board, setting up a “circle” in wonder-me (or facilitating a breakout group in Zoom), kicking off the conversation, and taking notes. These notes are usually presented back to the group in a final plenary, and/or compiled into a proceedings document/joint Miro board that is distributed electronically to all participants.

(Adapted from <https://www.ce-conference.org/menu-interactive-session-formats>)

PROJECT

Team up with your classmates, discuss on how to organize a conference by yourselves, and design the schedule of events for your conference.

Step 1 The following is an overview of the AAAL 2022 conference schedule. Please find out what session formats this conference has and how long each session lasts.

Step 2 Describe and discuss this conference schedule with your team members.

Step 3 Try to come up with a schedule for your own conference.

Schedule of Events

FRIDAY, MARCH 18

4:00 pm - 8:00 pm Registration Desk Open

SATURDAY, MARCH 19

7:00 am - 4:30 pm Registration Desk Open
8:00 am - 9:20 am Welcome, Opening Plenary - Uju Anya
9:20 am - 4:30 pm Exhibit Hall Open
9:20 am - 10:00 am Coffee Break (Exhibit Hall)
9:20 am - 10:00 am Poster Sessions
10:00 am - 12:00 pm Wilga Rivers Invited Colloquium
10:00 am - 12:15 pm Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
12:15 pm - 1:45 pm Lunch Break (*on your own*)
1:50 pm - 3:50 pm Invited Colloquium
1:50 pm - 3:50 pm Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
3:30 pm - 4:00 pm Coffee Break (Exhibit Hall)
3:30 pm - 4:00 pm Poster Sessions
4:00 pm - 5:05 pm Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
5:30 pm - 6:45 pm Plenary Speaker - Rodrigo Borba
6:45 pm - 8:00 pm Opening Reception (17th Floor - Urban)

SUNDAY, MARCH 20

7:30 am - 4:00 pm Registration Desk Open
8:00 am - 9:40 am Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
8:00 am - 10:00 am Invited Colloquium
8:00 am - 10:00 am Language Learning Roundtable
9:00 am - 4:30 pm Exhibit Hall Open
9:40 am - 10:10 am Coffee Break (Exhibit Hall)
9:40 am - 10:10 am Poster Sessions
10:10 am - 11:15 am Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
11:20 am - 12:30 pm Plenary Speaker - Keiko Koda
12:30 pm - 1:45 pm Lunch Break (*on your own*)
1:50 pm - 3:30 pm Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
1:50 pm - 3:50 pm Invited Colloquium
3:30 pm - 4:00 pm Coffee Break (Exhibit Hall)
3:30 pm - 4:00 pm Poster Sessions
4:00 pm - 5:05 pm Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
5:30 pm - 6:35 pm Plenary Speaker - Tiffany Lee

MONDAY, MARCH 21

7:30 am - 4:00 pm Registration Desk Open
8:00 am - 10:00 am Invited Colloquium
8:00 am - 10:00 am Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
8:00 am - 5:05 pm Roundtable Discussions
9:00 am - 4:30 pm Exhibit Hall Open
9:40 am - 10:10 am Coffee Break (Exhibit Hall)
10:10 am - 11:15 am Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
11:20 am - 12:30 pm Plenary Speaker - Glenn Martinez
12:30 pm - 1:45 pm AAAL Business Meeting
12:30 pm - 1:45 pm Lunch Break (*on your own*)
1:50 pm - 3:50 pm Invited Colloquium
1:50 pm - 3:50 pm Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
3:30 pm - 4:00 pm Coffee Break (Exhibit Hall)
4:00 pm - 5:05 pm Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
5:30 pm - 6:35 pm Plenary Speaker - Hossein Nassaji

TUESDAY, MARCH 22

7:30 am - 11:30 am Registration Desk Open
8:00 am - 9:40 am Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
9:00 am - 11:30 am Exhibit Hall Open
9:40 am - 10:10 am Coffee Break (Exhibit Hall)
10:10 am - 12:25 pm Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
10:10 am - 12:10 pm AAAL/ILTA Invited Colloquium
12:30 pm - 1:45 pm Lunch Break (*on your own*)
1:50 pm - 2:55 pm Concurrent Sessions - Papers, Colloquia
3:00 pm - 4:30 pm Closing Reception (*Cash Bar*)

**Check the AAAL Conference app for more details
and additional special meetings & events*

CHECKLIST

☐	Recognize the benefits of attending international conferences.
☐	Acquire different methods for identifying academic conferences of interest.
☐	Know about the various formats of conference sessions.

☐	Understand who are involved in organizing a conference and their responsibilities.
☐	Have knowledge of what a conference timeline is like.
☐	Design a schedule of events for an international conference.

Unit 4

Call for Papers

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To understand the general components of a Call for Papers;
- To be familiar with the format of a Call for Papers of a particular conference;
- To be able to write an English Call for Papers for a specific conference in a proper style with appropriate expressions.



STRUCTURE

Papers and abstracts are required by most of the conferences held in the academic or professional fields for attending. A potential conference-goer can be invited only when his submission is accepted by the organizer. Then, how can a potential conference-goer get his paper accepted at a conference he is interested in? Without doubt, in his paper he should provide new and original work that has not previously been done or published, and follow certain rules or styles in conformity with the standard set forth by a specific conference. More importantly, he should carefully read and analyze the Call for Papers of a particular conference which is in the Internet, in professional journals or in the printed conference literature. A good understanding of every detail of instructions and guidelines in a Call for Papers will ensure a potential conference-goer's success in getting an invitation to a meeting.

Call for Papers(or Call for Abstracts) serves as a kind of advertisement that calls for the conference papers or abstracts. It is one of the most important meeting documents for participants of a particular conference to obtain their needed information. Though the style, content and format of a Call for Papers may vary from one conference to another, it generally includes the following information elements: the name, time and location/venue of a conference, conference objectives/aims, conference themes or topics, detailed instructive paper submission information, organizing institution and committee, and contact information.

Sample Analysis



征文通知 CALL FOR PAPERS



2020年7月27-29日, 辽宁·沈阳
July 27-29, 2020, Shenyang, Liaoning



Call for Papers

The 39th Chinese Control Conference (CCC2020)

Shenyang, Liaoning, China

July 27 - 29, 2020

Sponsored by

the Technical Committee on Control Theory (TCCT), Chinese Association of
Automation (CAA)

Organized by

Northeastern University

In Cooperation with

IEEE Control System Society

General information

The 39th Chinese Control Conference (CCC2020) will be held in Shenyang, China, July 27 to 29, 2020. The CCC is an annual international conference, which aims to bring together the international community of systems and control to present the latest findings on control theories and technologies. The CCC2020 consists of plenary talks, invited sessions, panel discussions, pre-conference workshops, oral sessions and poster sessions.

Paper submission

Submissions of substantial, original and previously unpublished work are invited in the following areas related to the themes of the conference:

- System Theory and Control Theory
- Signal Processing and Information Fusion
- Big Data Analysis and Control
- System Modeling and Identification
- Sensor Networks and Internet of Things
- Vehicle and Transportation System Control
- Intelligent Manufacturing and Industrial Intelligence
- Information Systems and Network Security

Papers must be written in English. Submissions must not exceed six pages for regular papers or four pages for short papers. Each paper should be accompanied by a title page which includes paper title and author's information (name, affiliation, postal address, E-mail address and phone number), an abstract of less than 200 words and 3 – 5 keywords. The length of the final camera-ready paper will be limited to six pages for regular papers or four pages for short papers. All papers should be submitted online via <http://conf.neu.edu.cn/ccc2020/>.

The deadline for submission of papers is December 15, 2019. Papers received after this date will be rejected without review. Notification of receipt of papers will be sent electronically to the corresponding author soon after receipt.

Policy of multiple submissions

The CCC2020 will not accept any paper which has already been published

or is under review for publishing in a journal, book or presentation at another conference. And authors should not submit their papers elsewhere during the review period.

Paper presentation

Accepted papers may be presented orally or electronically (by PPT with voice). The conference organizers will provide presenters with necessary facilities for paper presentation including projectors and computers.

Important dates

Opening date for paper submission	October 1, 2019
Deadline for paper submission	December 15, 2019
Notification of acceptance	April 1, 2020
Receipt of final papers	April 30, 2020

Further information can be found at <http://conf.neu.edu.cn/ccc2020/>, <http://tcct.amss.ac.cn/>.

It can be seen, from the above sample Call for Papers, the conference has a formal name known as the 39th Chinese Control Conference (CCC2020). With its location/venue in Shenyang, the CCC2020 starts and ends on July 27 and 29, 2020 respectively. Sponsored by the Technical Committee on Control Theory (TCCT) and Chinese Association of Automation (CAA), the CCC2020 is organized by Northeastern University and IEEE Control System Society. Its objective or theme is to bring together researchers from academies and industry, and engineers all over the world, offering them invaluable opportunities to present their latest theoretical and technical findings in the field of systems and control.

In terms of paper submission, the Call for Papers of the CCC2020 provides authors of papers with a lot of instructive and informative information. This includes information on the following:

- Abstract: the length and format of the abstract.
- Full text: the subject areas of the paper; the deadline, length, written

language and format of the paper; notification of receipt of papers.

- Policy of multiple submissions; authors are not permitted to submit their papers elsewhere during the review period.
- Mode of presentation; presentations with visual or audio devices, that is, oral presentation or electronical presentation by PPT with voice.

Finally, the Call for Papers of the CCC2020 offers two websites to authors of papers who might need more information about the conference.

For the sake of clarity, the structure of the sample Call for Papers is presented in the following table.

Table 1 Major components of the sample Call for Papers

Part	Major components
1	Name, time and venue of a conference
2	Conference objectives/aims; conference themes/topics
3	Organizing institution and committee
4	Information on paper submission/requirements for papers (the length and format of the abstract; the subject areas of the paper; the deadline, length, written language and format of the paper; policy of multiple submissions; mode of presentation, etc.)
5	Contact information

Tasks

1. Read each of the following sentences chosen from Calls for Papers and decide what information element it is.

- 1) The goal of this conference is to bring together researchers and practitioners from academia and industry to focus on areas of literary and social studies for a cross-cultural exploration and subsequent innovation of subjects concerned.
()
- 2) Submissions must be original and should not have been published previously or be under consideration for publication while being evaluated for this

conference. ()

- 3) The 15th International Conference on Communication Systems and Networks will be held in Bangalore, India, during January 3 – 8, 2023. ()
- 4) Papers submitted to this international conference should be prepared in standard IEEE conference format and should contain no more than eight pages of technical content, plus one page of references. ()
- 5) Submissions will be double-blind; reviewers cannot see authors' names when conducting reviews, and authors cannot see reviewers' names. ()
- 6) For updates and information, please feel free to contact the ACDDE 2018 organization team through *Nakazawa-sayuri-xb@ynu.ac.jp*. ()
- 7) This international conference is co-organized by Japan Society of Mechanical Engineers and China Society for Industrial and Applied Mathematics.
- 8) There will be a strict upper limit of nine pages for the main text of the submission, with unlimited additional page for citations.

2. The following is a Call for Papers. Read it through and then finish two exercises after it.

Call for Papers

The Asian Conference on Design and Digital Engineering 2018 (ACDDE 2018) will take place during Nov. 1 – 3, 2018 in Okinawa Zanzanmisaki Royal Hotel, Yomitanson, Okinawa, Japan. ACDDE is an annual international conference which covers state-of-the-art developments in design and digital engineering technologies as well as scientific, industrial, and business applications.

Scope

ACDDE 2018 is organized as a collection of 6 workshops. An author should select a workshop based on the topics. Topics of interest include (but are not limited to):

- Geometric Computing, Approximating and Processing Workshop
- Computational Design and Optimization Workshop
- Visual Media and Interaction Workshop
- Emerging Applications of CAD Workshop
- PLM & Smart Manufacturing Workshop

- Design & Architecture & Shipbuilding Workshop

Paper submission

English is the official language of the conference. Manuscripts must be written in English. For format details and templates, please visit the conference website: <http://acdde2018.org/>

Important dates

Authors can choose submission type; Paper presentation or Oral presentation only.

Paper Presentation

Abstract submission	May 11 (Fri.)
Abstract acceptance notification	May 18 (Fri.)
Full paper submission for review	June 22 (Fri.)
Paper acceptance notification	August 24 (Fri.)
Final paper submission	September 21 (Fri.)

Oral Presentation

Abstract submission	August 31 (Fri.)
Abstract acceptance notification	September 14 (Fri.)
Presentation slide submission	October 5 (Fri.)

Organizing institution and committee

Co-organized by

Japan Society of Mechanical Engineers
Society for Computational Design and Engineering
China Society for Industrial and Applied Mathematics

Contacts

For updates and information, please visit the conference website: <http://acdde2018.org/>

- 1) Answer the following questions briefly.
 - a. When and where will the conference be held?
 - b. Who is organizing the conference?
 - c. When should authors submit their abstracts if they choose oral presentation only?

- 2) Discuss with your partners and tell whether the Call for Papers of the ACDDE 2018 has the same components as the sample Call for Papers of the CCC2020. What are these components? Are they in the same order? Give reasons for your answer.

CULTURAL NOTES

Nowadays there are a multitude of meetings held worldwide every year. And different names (meeting, conference, workshop and session) are used for different meetings as we can see from the above two Calls for Papers. As a potential participant of these different meetings, having good knowledge of the differences among these different terms is especially important. Here are the names for different meetings.

- **Meeting**

Meeting is a general term for people assembled for a particular purpose. Its original meaning is to “meet with each other”, or to “put heads together”. In this sense, if there are more than two persons coming together, talking and discussing, this event can be called a meeting.

- **Conference**

Conference is a kind of formal meeting, often lasting for a few days. It is organized on a particular subject to bring together people who have common interests. At a conference, formal discussions usually take place. So conference generally refers to a professional or academic event.

- **Symposium**

Symposium, with symposia or symposiums as its plural form, is also a kind of meeting. It refers exclusively to the meetings for specialized academic discussion. Compared with conference, a symposium is usually narrower and more specific in the range of topics.

- **Congress**

The basic characteristic of a congress is that it is usually attended by representatives or delegates who belong to national or international, governmental or non-governmental organizations. It is held to discuss issues, and policies of public

interest. As a meeting, congress is usually rather large in scale and generally representative and extensive.

- **Convention**

Convention is a kind of routine meeting, at which a large gathering of people meet and discuss the business of their organization. Usually it is regularly organized.

- **Forum**

Forum is a kind of public meeting, at which people exchange ideas and discuss issues, especially important public issues.

- **Seminar**

Seminar is usually a class-like meeting, at which participants discuss a particular topic or subject presented by several major speakers. A seminar can be taken as lecturing plus discussion.

- **Workshop**

Regarding meeting, workshop refers to a period of discussion or practical work on a particular subject in which a group of people learn about the subject by sharing their knowledge or experience. Workshop lays emphasis on practical performance. Therefore, arranged in a workshop may be many relevant activities such as demonstrations, displays and operations during the course of presentation.

- **Colloquium**

Colloquium is a formal word for a large academic seminar. It is usually attended by certain invited experts or professionals in a particular field. Participants of the meeting will express their ideas and opinions on a specific topic.

- **Session**

Session is a formal meeting or series of meetings of a court and a parliament. It also refers to a period of time when such meetings are held.

LANGUAGE FOCUS

In Call for Papers, possible participants of a conference are bound to find one of the most important information elements—detailed requirements for paper

submission. These requirements are in fact instructions or guidelines to authors of papers, which are concerned with styles, formats and contents of papers. If authors can understand every detail in these instructions, they may have a clear idea of some common practices for conference papers and thus have a greater chance of getting invitations from the conference committee. Here are some specific instructions on styles and formats of papers, and their examples.

Table 2 Instructions on styles and formats of papers, and their examples

Aspects	Examples
General Instructions (Typeface, typesize, line spacing and indenting; type area)	• Use “Times New Roman” 12 point size and 13 point line spacing. • Indent the first line of each paragraph one em-quad. • Use only one side of the paper. The text should fit exactly into the type area (187×270 mm), and the width of each column should be 90 mm, not more and not less.
Layout of Text (Title of paper)	• Type the title of your paper in lower case at the top of the first page. It should be no longer than seventy characters.
Layout of Text (Headings)	• Type primary headings in capital letters roman and secondary headings in lower case.
Layout of Text (Abstract)	• Type the word ABSTRACT followed directly by the abstract itself, which should run over both columns.
Layout of Text (Text)	• All text should be justified/aligned. • All text should be unjustified, ragged on the right margin.

continued

Aspects	Examples
Layout of Text (Figures and tables)	• <i>No figures should be set next to text in the same column.</i> • <i>Locate tables close to the first reference to them in the text.</i>
References	• <i>List all references in alphabetical order at the end of the paper.</i>

Useful Expressions

- **Regarding paper submission dates**

- 1) The CCC2020 Secretariat must receive your paper by December 15, 2019.
- 2) Titles of proposed papers with a 200-word abstract should be submitted no later than March 5, 2020.
- 3) The deadline for paper submission is July 4, 2021.
- 4) Submission is due on March 8, 2018.

- **Regarding the content of invited papers**

- 1) The submitted papers should be original and not have been published elsewhere.
- 2) The paper to be submitted to a conference must be in conformity with the special theme or topics for discussion of the conference.
- 3) Best papers will be selected by the Advisory Committee and Program Committee, and the authors are invited to submit their papers to a prestigious international journal.
- 4) For all submissions please include the following information: title of paper, author's name and affiliation, phone number and e-mail address.

- **Regarding the format and length of papers/abstracts**

- 1) Abstracts should be submitted electronically in PDF format and sent by e-mail to conference secretariat.
- 2) Authors of accepted papers should send the full text paper in MS Word format to ccc@amss.ac.cn with e-mail attachment.

- 3) All submissions should be in either PDF or MS Word format.
- 4) Submissions must not exceed six pages for regular papers or four pages for short papers.
- 5) Initial/Final paper submissions should be approximately eight pages.
- 6) Length of the paper is not restricted and we invite solid technical input and detailed diagrams.

• **Regarding paper acceptance or rejection**

- 1) Submissions before July 15, 2019 will be given primary consideration.
- 2) Papers with high quality technical contents will be accepted.
- 3) Acceptance of the paper will be confirmed by the Program Committee based on the content and quality of the extended abstract.
- 4) If you are unable to meet the deadline, your paper will not be included in the proceedings.
- 5) Late paper submissions will result in the papers being excluded from the conference proceedings.

Tasks

1. Translate the following sentences into English.

- 1) 论文采用网上投稿,请在 10 月 30 日前登录网站(<http://conf.neu.edu.cn/>)并完成投稿。

- 2) 此次会议的中文摘要限 1000 字。

- 3) 第十九届国际城市语言学会年会将在南京举行,现公开征集稿件。

- 4) 请附上以下个人资料:论文题目、作者姓名、所属单位、通讯地址。

5) 记住论文提交的截止日期为 2023 年 5 月 6 日。

2. Complete the following five sentences taken from Instructions to Authors of Papers of a conference with the information provided in the box below.

- A. with good contrast and on glossy paper
 - B. Leave two blank lines
 - C. to denote vectors in mathematics
 - D. in order to ensure uniform style
 - E. Number figures consecutively in the order

- 1) All the papers have to be prepared strictly according to the instructions set by the organizer _____.
- 2) Never use bold, except _____.
- 3) _____ before starting the text of the paper.
- 4) _____ in which reference is made to them in the text, making no distinction between diagrams and photographs.
- 5) Photographs should be black and white, _____.

3. Read the following pieces of information and then design a Call for Papers based on the instructions given below.

- 1) Acceptance of the paper will be confirmed by COMSNETS 2023 Program Committee based on the technical content of the extended abstract. Notification of acceptance will be sent on December 25, 2022.
- 2) COMSNETS 2023 topics of interest include, but are not limited to the following:
 - Wireless
 - Data Center & Edge
 - Green Networking
 - Network Architecture
 - Mobility & Internet of Things
 - Blockchain & Security

- Testbeds
- 3) The submitted paper should provide work that has salient concepts and embodies novel features.
 - 4) COMSNETS 2023 will consist of two major streams of presentations: Technology Stream and Industry Stream.
 - 5) COMSNETS 2023 Secretariat
 - 6) Authors of accepted papers should send the full text paper in the format of PDF or MS Word to *comsnets_conference@gmail.com* with an attachment.
 - 7) Extended abstract should be written in English and satisfy the following requirements: less than three A4 pages in length, and with typeface larger than point 10.
 - 8) COMSNETS 2023 will be held in Bangalore, India during January 3 – 8, 2023.
 - 9) It is an important international conference dedicated to advances in Networking and Communication Systems.

Call for Papers	
Part 1	General information
Part 2	Specific instructions on the format of papers and abstracts
Part 3	Enquiry

PROJECT

Suppose your faculty, School of Artificial Intelligence, is going to hold an important international conference on Design and Control of Automated Vehicle. Work with your group members and write an English Call for Papers for this conference. Remember the Call for Papers should include the following information elements:

- Name, location/venue of the conference;
- Date (starting and ending date) of the conference;

- Objectives/aims and themes of the conference;
- Instructive and informative information on paper submission, including information on abstract/full text/mode of presentation, etc.;
- Organizing institution and committee;
- Contact information.

CHECKLIST

☐	Understand what is a Call for Papers.
☐	Know what should be included in a Call for Papers.
☐	Have a good idea of the format and content when reading a Call for Papers of a particular conference.
☐	Know how to tell the differences between different meetings.
☐	Understand every detail in instructions to authors of papers when reading a Call for Papers of a special conference.
☐	Write a Call for Papers for an academic or a professional conference.

Unit 5

Opening Speeches

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To identify language features of opening speeches with proper examples;
- To write an opening speech with necessary components;
- To present an opening speech with appropriate expressions.



STRUCTURE

Opening speech signals the start of any special event or occasion requiring a formal opening. It is also called Welcome speech. It is a speech delivered at the opening session of a conference. It is usually delivered by the chairperson or a well-known authority in the field or a distinguished guest. As a prelude to a conference, it sets the keynote of the conference. Usually, it lasts for 1 to 2 minutes, but can be longer for grander events.

Generally, opening speech speaker will salute the audience, acknowledge and welcome any important guests, welcome and thank all the guests, state the name of the event, thank the organizations/individuals involved, introduce the history/backgrounds of the event, give information about the contents and purposes of this conference, and conclude with good wishes to the conference and the participants.

Sample Analysis

Table 1 Major components of the sample introduction

Paragraphs	Major components
Dear fellow Olympians, Your Excellency, Xi Jinping, President of the People's Republic of China, Your Excellencies, Antonio Guterres, Secretary-General of the United Nations, and Abdulla Shahid, President of the UN General Assembly, President of the Organising Committee, Cai Qi, Your Excellencies, Dear Olympic friends,	• Salutation

continued

Paragraphs	Major components
Welcome to the Olympic Winter Games Beijing 2022.	• Expressing welcome
This Year of the Tiger is also an Olympic Year. Both the Year of the Tiger and the Olympic Year stand for ambition, courage and strength. Today, thanks to this ambition, China is a winter sport country. Well over 300 million people are engaged in winter sports in about 2,000 ski resorts and ice rinks. This extraordinary achievement opens a new era for global winter sport. It will raise the global participation to new levels, benefiting the Chinese people as well as winter sport enthusiasts around the world.	• Providing background
We can only write this new chapter in sporting history, because of our gracious hosts—the Chinese people, whom we thank wholeheartedly for welcoming us all so warmly. Thank you, our Chinese friends! A special thanks goes to all the volunteers. You make us feel at home from the very first moment we arrived. Your smiling eyes are warming our hearts. Thank you volunteers.	• Expressing gratitude/ thanks

continued

Paragraphs	Major components
Unfortunately, the global pandemic is still a reality for all of us. Therefore, our gratitude is even deeper for the Beijing 2022 Organising Committee, the public authorities and all the Chinese people. Thank you for making these Olympic Winter Games happen—and making them happen in a safe way for everyone. We all could only get here because of the countless medical workers, doctors, scientists, everybody in China and around the world who is going beyond the call of duty. Thank you for your outstanding efforts and solidarity.	
Dear fellow Olympians, your Olympic stage is set. You have arrived here after overcoming so many challenges, living through great uncertainty. But now your moment has come, the moment you have been longing for the moment we all have been longing for. Now, your Olympic dream is coming true—in magnificent venues, supported by hundreds of millions of new Chinese winter sport fans. You, the Olympic athletes, you will show how the world would look like, if we all respect the same rules and each other.	• Giving information about the contents and purposes of this Olympic Games

continued

Paragraphs	Major components
Over the next two weeks you will compete with each other for the highest prize. At the same time, you will live peacefully together under one roof in the Olympic Village. There will be no discrimination for any reason whatsoever. In our fragile world, where division, conflict and mistrust are on the rise, we show the world: yes, it is possible to be fierce rivals, while at the same time living peacefully and respectfully together. This is the mission of the Olympic Games: bringing us together in peaceful competition; always building bridges, never erecting walls; uniting humankind in all our diversity.	
Dear athletes, we all are standing with you. We all are supporting you. We all are cheering you on. May this encourage you to go faster, to aim higher, to become stronger together. In this way you will inspire the world in this Olympic Year with the same ambition, courage and strength like the Year of the Tiger.	• Expressing best wishes
Now I have the honour of inviting the President of the People's Republic of China, His Excellency Xi Jinping, to declare open the 24th Olympic Winter Games Beijing 2022.	• Inviting the declaration

(Adapted from IOC President's speech—Beijing 2022 Opening Ceremony)

Tasks

1. Match each sentence with the corresponding component it demonstrates.

A. Salutation
B. Expressing welcome
C. Providing background
D. Expressing gratitude/thanks
E. Giving information about the contents and purposes of this conference
F. Expressing best wishes
G. Inviting the declaration

- 1) I believe, by way of this conference, the relationship between us will be strengthened and we will innovate more beneficial solutions through the use of artificial intelligence technologies. ()
- 2) My special thanks go to those who have travelled great distances and taken valuable time from their very busy schedules to attend the conference. ()
- 3) My dear colleagues, ()
- 4) On behalf of Nanjing Municipal Government, I am honoured to have the opportunity to welcome you all to Nanjing to participate in this conference. ()
- 5) The International Association for Cross-Cultural Psychology was founded in Hong Kong in 1972. It has undertaken 20 congresses in many countries of the world in over 30 years. ()
- 6) I would like to invite President Hu to declare the opening of this conference. ()
- 7) Our purpose in holding this conference is to share our experience and knowledge in regard to the theory, new developments, and possible applications of these two promising techniques. ()

2. Match each paragraph of the following sample opening speech in Column A with a letter in Column B.

Column A	Column B
Dear Colleagues, (1)	A. Expressing gratitude/ thanks
On behalf of the Organizing Committee, I warmly welcome you to the 21 st International Congress of Biology. (2)	B. Giving information about the contents of this conference
There are more than 25 interesting symposia, covering a wide range of branches of biology. Some symposia will present recent advances of biology, using modern biological techniques. Some will present new discoveries and applications of traditional biology, and others will discuss philosophy and ethics of biology. We are honoured to invite some distinguished biologists to give plenary speeches. (3)	C. Expressing best wishes
Nowadays, we face more environmental challenges than ever before. Fortunately, we have become more capable in dealing with these challenges in the rapid development of modern biology. (4)	D. Salutation
I sincerely hope that participants worldwide will take this opportunity to exchange ideas, and to promote our capacity for solving the conflicts between wildlife and humans. I wish the congress will be successful and productive. (5)	E. Inviting the declaration
	F. Expressing welcome
	G. Providing background

3. Discuss with your partners to determine whether the two opening speeches are with the same components, whether their components appear in the same order, and whether they are used in the same situation. Please give reasons about your results.

CULTURAL NOTES

The Beijing 2022 Winter Olympic and Paralympic Games have inspired an increasing number of people to take up sports, including ice and snow sports, thereby boosting the overall sports industry.



Thanks to younger sports enthusiasts and the diverse sports and tourism trends, the country's ice and snow industry, along with winter sports and tourism development programs will boost the overall economy and high-quality development.

The country can benefit from the Winter Games legacy, too, by developing the construction, transportation, manufacturing and service sectors of the ice and snow sports economy. In fact, the authorities have announced that the sports facilities in Beijing and Zhangjiakou will be opened to the public after the Winter Games. This will unleash the development potential of the sites and boost consumption.

The fact that people will be encouraged to visit Winter Games' venues and people from the southern parts of China will comprise a big section of consumers

in the winter sports market will help boost economic growth in both urban and rural areas. And the integration of various industries, due mainly to the Winter Games, will help the development of an array of new businesses and improve the management of sporting events.

The Winter Games have also provided an opportunity for China to adjust the supply and demand structure, transform the traditional industries, speed up urbanization, become more adept at hosting international events, and bolster the sustainable development of the sports industry.

*(Adapted from China Daily/Olympic legacy to boost winter sports industry,
<https://xcb.sus.edu.cn/info/1020/4699.htm>)*

LANGUAGE FOCUS

Language Features

1. Formal vs. Informal

FORMAL ENGLISH	INFORMAL ENGLISH
• It is used in academic writing (e.g., essays, reports, resumes, theses, and the like), and formal social events such as public speeches, graduation ceremonies, and assemblies depending upon the topic.	• It is suitable for ordinary conversations or letters to friends.
• It is more commonly used in writing than in speech. • It follows the conventions of “standard” language. It uses language forms that often grammatically and lexically considered “correct” or agreed upon by most educated users of the language. For example, sentences are often long and complex.	• It is more used in everyday speech (esp., conversations) than in writing. • It often violates the conventions of “standard” language. For example, sentences are often short (or choppy) and simple.

continued

FORMAL ENGLISH	INFORMAL ENGLISH
• Subject-verb agreement is observed.	• Subject-verb agreement is not necessarily observed.
• Contractions are avoided.	• Contractions and acronyms are very common.
• The passive voice is often used (making it more impersonal).	• The active voice is often used.
• It is better organized and thought out.	• It is less organized and thought out.
• The past tense of modal auxiliaries is common, and so on. • Clear and precise vocabulary is used. Hence, clichés, colloquialisms, idioms, phrasal verbs, proverbs and slang are avoided. Likewise, a lot of synonyms are used in order to avoid the repetition of the same words. Also, much vocabulary derived from French and Latin is used.	• The present tense of modal auxiliaries is common, and so on. • Vocabulary use is somewhat liberal; hence, lots of clichés, colloquialisms, idioms, phrasal verbs, proverbs and slang are often used. Also, vocabulary derived from French and Latin is not common.
• Polite words and formulas like <i>Please</i>, <i>Thank you</i>, <i>Madam</i>, <i>Sir</i>, <i>Mr./Mrs./Miss/Ms.</i>, <i>Would you mind ...</i>, <i>May I ...</i>, <i>Could you please ...</i>, etc., are often used in speech.	• Words that express rapport and familiarity are often used in speech, such as <i>brother</i>, <i>buddy</i>, <i>man</i>, <i>you know</i>, and the like.
• When spoken, words are more carefully and more slowly pronounced than in informal English.	• When spoken, words are less carefully and more quickly pronounced (often chopped) than in formal English.

(Adapted from *Inglés IV* (B-2008) Prof. Argenis A. Zapata
<https://www.docin.com/p-1046431305.html> & isPay = 1)

From the table above, we can see that opening speech as public speech, its language style belongs to the formal language. When delivering opening speech, the characteristics of formal language should be carefully considered.

2. Conciseness

Conciseness means terseness and economy in writing and speaking achieved by expressing a great deal of in just a few words. For example, “Bill loves to go to the movies because watching films is a real pleasure to him” is not as concise as “Bill loves to watch movies.” In opening speech, although formal English is commonly used, it does not mean the speech should be very long and complex. In order to complete the speech in a set time, it should follow the principle of conciseness instead of lengthiness, or opening speech will be boring and distracting.

(<https://www.thefreedictionary.com/conciseness>
<https://www.dictionary.com/browse/conciseness>)

Useful Expressions

• Salutation and greetings

- 1) Ladies and gentlemen, good morning!
- 2) Distinguished guests, good evening!

• Expressing welcome and thanks

- 1) On behalf of the sponsors, the School of Nursing, University of Ottawa, and Tianjin Medical College, I would like to express a very warm welcome to the guests, experts and delegates who have traveled here to participate in this academic conference. I would also like to express our heartfelt thanks to all the organizations and friends, who have helped and supported us in organizing this conference.
- 2) Please allow me on behalf of the organizing committee to extend my warmest congratulations on the convening of this conference. I would also like to warmly welcome you—all the participants home and abroad to the conference.

• Introducing the background

- 1) The decision to plan this meeting resulted from a growing awareness that

the clinical problems associated with this disease are increasing in number and complexity, that our understanding of the basic mechanisms is deficient, and that our current therapy of this disease and its complications should be critically evaluated.

- 2) Three years ago, at the 7th International Conference on Linguistics Studies, I suggested that an international symposium on learning strategies be held, Dr. Gu and Dr. Cohen agreed. We are now very glad to have the opportunity of holding the 8th international conference in Nanjing.

• **Introducing the theme and the program**

- 1) This is the first conference in this field in which such a varied group has assembled, including sociologists, psychologists, clinicians, nurses, architects, and even system engineers. Many of these investigators have made important, collaborative contributions to this particular field of our common interest at the experimental and conceptual levels.
- 2) The meeting will tackle the key questions of assessing quality, effectiveness, and appropriateness of not only medical devices, equipment, and pharmaceuticals, but all procedures and processes for prevention, treatment and rehabilitation, as well as assessments in the public health context.

• **Expressing good wishes**

- 1) We expect that this conference will offer an opportunity for all participants to form personal ties and above all, to exchange results, ideas and projects, from which progress will derive.
- 2) I believe, by way of this conference, the relationship between us will be strengthened and we will innovate more beneficial solutions through the use of artificial intelligence technologies.

• **Declaring opening**

- 1) Now it is my privilege to announce the opening of the meeting.
- 2) It is my great honor to declare the opening of the conference.

Tasks

1. Translate the following sentences into English.

- 1) 我要感谢你们所有人的关心和努力,帮助我们使本次会议成为可能。

2) 对于没有参加上次会议的各位,我想简要介绍一下这一系列会议的背景。

3) 会议有 50 多个有趣的专题讨论会,涵盖语言学的各个分支。

4) 此次会议旨在展示尖端芯片的进步,促进全球合作,培养新一代科学家。

5) 最后,我祝愿会议取得圆满成功。

2. The following passages are from two opening speeches for the same conference. Compare the two versions, and discuss the questions below.

1) Which version is more suitable for an opening speech?

2) What leads to your answer?

Version A

Ladies and gentlemen,

It is my great honour to welcome you to this conference. Although the weather outside is rather annoying, it cannot ice the warm atmosphere right here. I would love to express my deepest thanks to every participant from all over the world ...

Version B

Hello,

Everybody! How do ya do? It's raining cats and dogs. I'd love to express my warmest welcome to you guys here and there in the world. Thanks'll go to you man from the bottom of my heart ...

3. Study the following opening speech which needs revision and work on the two tasks.

- 1) Discuss why it needs revision.
- 2) Rewrite this opening speech based on the discussion and what you have learnt.

President,
Professors,
Colleagues and Friends,
Ladies and Gentlemen,

I warmly welcome you to the 2nd International Conference of Fire Science that includes more than 30 interesting symposia that cover a wide range of branches of fire science such as performance based fire protection, education of fire self-rescue, flame retardant material, insulation material fire, fire dynamics simulation and fire protection codes. We are honoured to invite some experts who are very good at educating the public about fire science to give plenary speeches.

In this new century, with rapid and ongoing industrialization, the fire safety problems of constructions and equipment: large space building fires, forest fire, tunnel fire, planes and ships fire, and so on. Fortunately, we have become more capable of dealing with these challenges with the rapid development of fire protection techniques. I sincerely hope that participants who come from every corner of the world will take this opportunity to exchange ideas, to enhance collaboration, to establish friendships for the future of fire science research and to promote our capacity of preventing fire hazard and extinguishing fire.

I wish the conference will be successful and productive, and wish you guys to have a very pleasant and memorable experience in the beautiful and historical city of Xuzhou.

(<http://www.doczj.com/doc/999053869.html>)

- 4. Suppose you were a vice President of Tianjin University, going to deliver an opening speech at 2022 4th International Conference on Civil Architecture and Urban Engineering. Write an opening speech according to the given situation.**

Welcome to ICCAUE 2022

2022 4th International Conference on Civil Architecture and Urban Engineering (ICCAUE 2022) is jointly sponsored by Tianjin Port Engineering Institute Co., Ltd. of CCCC First Harbor Engineering Co., Ltd., Tianjin University and organized by AEIC Academic Exchange Information Center. Conference will be held on June 24 – 26, 2022, in Xining, China.

The conference is an international conference for the presentation of technological advances and research results in the fields of civil architecture and urban engineering. The conference will bring together leading researchers, engineers and scientists in the domain of interest from around the world. We warmly welcome previous and prospected authors submit your new research papers to ICCAUE 2022, and share the valuable experiences with the scientists and scholars around the world.

2021 3rd International Conference on Civil Architecture and Urban Engineering (ICCAUE 2021) was successfully held as online conference on June 11, 2021.

2020 2nd International Conference on Civil Architecture and Urban Engineering (ICCAUE 2020) was successfully held on August 14 – 16, 2020 in Xi'an, China.

2019 International Conference on Civil Architecture and Urban Engineering (ICCAUE 2019) was successfully held on October 18 – 20, 2019 in Chongqing, China.

continued

• **Hosts**

Tianjin Port Engineering Institute Co., Ltd. of CCCC First Harbor Engineering Co., Ltd.

Tianjin University

• **Organizer**

AEIC Academic Exchange Information Center

(<http://www.iccaue.org/>)

PROJECT

Write an opening speech for a simulated international conference as part of your group work in the following suggested steps.

- Step 1** Discuss with your group members and decide on the topic of the simulated international conference.
- Step 2** Understand the background of the simulated international conference.
- Step 3** Determine who will deliver the opening speech in your group.
- Step 4** Make clear the title of the opening speech speaker.
- Step 5** Include the necessary components of the opening speech in the speech draft.
- Step 6** Write the opening speech in formal English.
- Step 7** Write the opening speech in concise English.
- Step 8** Practice and get ready to present the opening speech in the next class.

CHECKLIST

☐	Understand the structure of an opening speech.
☐	Identify features of different types of opening speeches.
☐	Get familiar with the necessary information components of an opening speech.
☐	Tell the differences between of formal and informal English.
☐	Understand the definition of concise English.
☐	Learn how to use the formal and concise English style of an opening speech.
☐	Write an opening speech with necessary components and appropriate language styles.
☐	Deliver an opening speech in public.

Unit 6

Introducing Keynote Speakers

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To be aware of the specificity of the introduction;
- To synthesize the relevant online information about the keynote speaker;
- To write an introductory speech with necessary components;
- To present an introductory speech with appropriate expressions.



STRUCTURE

A strong introduction is important because it builds up audience anticipation for who they are about to see and it also makes the speaker feel genuinely acknowledged and respected for being invited to the event. Without a good introduction, the audience will not have a strong enough reason to be open to the speaker's ideas because they might not know the credibility of the speaker. So an introductory speaker should take out the effort to craft a great keynote speaker introduction.

An introduction is also a short speech, not reading from the biography or a CV. So it's important you take your time out to deliver one that does justice to both the speaker and yourself!

The Speaker Introduction has roughly four major parts that address a different question in turn. Combining these parts together has a nice flow to it and it builds up to a strong finish.

Why Is This Subject Important?

This allows you to start with an attention-getter—to pose a question, state an alarming fact, interesting insight or staggering statistic. The main purpose is to grab the audience's attention, to stop them thinking about the previous presentation or even just to look up from their phone where they have been checking their email.

It can be as short as just a sentence or perhaps two or three to frame the topic. For example:

- 1) *Did you know that there are more shopping malls in America than there are high schools?*
- 2) *Who here believes that ... is the biggest issue facing our industry at the moment?*

Why Is This Speaker Invited?

An introductory speaker needs to establish the credibility of the keynote speaker. This is where you mention some of the highlights taken from their biography or CV. Choose the most significant ones and importantly, the ones that relate most to the topic and theme. You are positioning the speaker as the best person who gives insights and solutions to the subject. For example:

- 1) *Mr. Yuan Longping was a world-famous agronomist, known for developing the first hybrid rice varieties in the 1970s.*
- 2) *Mr. Deng Jiaxian has made important contributions to the research and development of China's nuclear weapons and atomic weapons, and is known as the "two-bomb father".*

Why Does This Very Audience Need to Sit at the Presentation?

The introductory speaker needs to build a link between the subject or the keynote speaker and the audience. The introductory speaker needs to let them know how this subject can affect them directly. For example:

- 1) *You guys are leaders in our community ...*
- 2) *If you expect to avoid COVID infection next year ...*

Why Does the Audience Need to Listen to the Speech Right Now?

As an introducer, you need to highlight the following questions.

- Why is it great to learn this now?
- What are they going to get out of it?
- Why should they pay attention right now?

For example:

- 1) *In the next 30 minutes you will learn how to fix the pain of consumers after the pandemic.*
- 2) *Let's get some inside secrets from someone who ...*

Sample Analysis

Introductory speech	Elements
Ladies and gentlemen, dear chairman Smith, distinguished guests, Good morning, I'm Jessica Rich. First, I'd like to ask you a few questions. How many of you realize there are 5 scam phone calls every 5 minutes in the U.S.? How many of you know the loss of victims of scams could amount to trillions of dollars each year? Yes, everyone at this conference is a potential victim of a scam. Now it is my pleasure to introduce our first keynote speaker for the day. We are so pleased that Illinois Attorney General Lisa Madigan has agreed to provide a keynote address at her third consecutive Midwest Region Common Ground Conference. She is just the one who was called The Safeguard of The People by the president last month. As you know, Attorney General Madigan has been a national leader among the state Attorneys General in protecting consumers during the financial crisis. Under her leadership, the Consumer Protection Division of the Illinois Attorney General's Office has established a national reputation for aggressively safeguarding consumers from mortgage scams and other types of financial fraud. During her nearly twelve years as the Illinois Attorney General, Lisa Madigan has also	Greetings and Salutation Introduction • Two questions as the attention-getter Body • Name • Title • Previous attendance • Highlighting the award • Major achievements • Relationship and collaboration with the sponsor (FTC)

continued

Introductory speech	Elements
been a great friend of the FTC. Our Midwest Region office in Chicago, for example, recently teamed with Attorney General Madigan’s Office, and the AGs of Kentucky and North Carolina, to take down Fortune Hi-Tech Marketing, a massive pyramid scheme that operated throughout the country, particularly targeting immigrant and Spanish-speaking communities. I’m happy to report that earlier this week, a federal district judge in Kentucky approved a settlement in that case that will divest the defendants of much of their wealth and provide for almost \$ 8 million in restitution to the scheme’s victims. That case is just one of many examples of the cooperative relationship the FTC has enjoyed with Attorney General Madigan’s office. As part of our Chicago Fraud Task Force, we jointly plan enforcement and consumer education initiatives, including our extremely popular Shred Day event at Chicago’s United Center. After the adoption of the FTC’s MARS Rule, we teamed with Attorney General Madigan’s Office and the Illinois Attorney Registration & Disciplinary Commission to address the problem of attorneys fronting for MARS providers in order to circumvent the Rule’s ban on up-front payments. Attorney General Madigan then brought some of the first cases in the country against attorneys playing that role.	• Her current joint work with the introducer

continued

Introductory speech	Elements
She clearly is at the forefront of the consumer protection community. I'm proud to introduce Illinois Attorney General Lisa Madigan. She is going to talk about the challenges we are facing in the next decade. Please join me in welcoming Lisa Madigan.	Conclusion • General comment • Reannoucement of the name and title • Topic • Welcome

Note:

1. *This speech is adapted from Introduction of Keynote Speaker by Jessica Rich, Director of the Bureau of Consumer Protection, FTC (Federal Trade Commission 美国联邦贸易委员会), at the Common Ground Conference held in St. Louis, Missouri on May 1, 2014.*

2. *MARS Rule: Mortgage Assistance Relief Services Rule*

Research from diverse sources is necessary before a script for the introductory speech is prepared. What is available in most situations is only a biography that is searched via the searching engine or copied from their official website of the affiliations. However, a biography is not an introduction. A biography, like a CV that is put together to help the person obtain a job, lists all the qualifications, achievements, career highlights, publications, awards, etc. But the audience doesn't really need to know all this. They want to essentially know just three things about the speaker. Is this topic important? Is the speaker qualified to talk about the topic? What's in it for them?

The introductory speaker should also do some research about the event and answer a few questions that specifically relate to the event. What is the purpose of the whole meeting? What is the purpose of this speech? Why do they choose this speaker?

There is no template or fixed pattern for an introduction that is suitable for every keynote speaker in every event, so an excellent introduction should definitely be crafted and customized for the specific speaker to the specific audience

in the specific event based on the 4-part framework or the answers to the above questions instead of reading from the biography given.

Usually an introductory speech, like any other formal speeches, is composed of three parts, the introduction, the body and the conclusion. The introduction or an opening usually starts with greetings, self-introduction if necessary, and ends with an hook to interest or motivate the audience. The body part then should usually include the speakers' profession, education background if either the keynote speaker or the introducer thinks it matters, and the reputation and major achievements that make them distinguished from others. Finally, the speech is often concluded with the subject or title of the speech and a warm welcome. The structure of the sample introduction is presented in Table 1.

As we can see from the first paragraph, after the greeting and self-introduction, the introducer asks the audience two questions with astonishing data about scams in the U.S., which serve as the hook to get the attention from the audience to the importance of the topic, and also an induction to the keynote speaker who is professionally involved in the fight against scams and fraud.

The second paragraph presents the keynote speaker's name, the title, previous attendance to the conference. It also highlights the award she has just received from the president to make her feel fully respected, and conveys the message that the speaker is highly qualified for the topic as well, so as to raise the audience's expectations.

Paragraph 3 to 5 introduce her major professional achievements, her relationship and collaboration with the sponsor(FTC) with an example, and her current joint work with the introducer. The introducer presents all the above facts to show her nation-wide fame, the extraordinary contributions she made to protect consumers' interests and enforce government rules.

Finally, the speech is concluded with a general comment and reannouncement of the keynote speaker's name and title, an introduction of the topic of the presentation, and ends with a warm welcome.

Table 1 Major components of the sample introduction

Part	Paragraph	Major components
1	1	greetings, self-introduction, the hook
2	2	overview of the profession
3	3 – 5	the reputation and achievements
4	6	subject of the speech, welcome

Tasks

1. Discuss why there is no education background of the speaker in the sample script.

2. Match each sentence with the corresponding question it addresses.

- A. Why is this subject important?

B. Why is this speaker invited?

C. Why does this very audience need to sit at the presentation?

D. Why does the audience need to listen to the speech right now?

- 1) Under her leadership, the Consumer Protection Division of the Illinois Attorney General's Office has established a national reputation for aggressively safeguarding consumers from mortgage scams and other types of financial fraud. ()
- 2) What do you think is the most common cause of death of children under 5 years worldwide? ()
- 3) John Smith will prove today that anyone can give a charismatic speech and that a little bit of anxiety isn't always bad news. ()
- 4) Su Bingtian, the fastest man in Asia, set a new Asian record in the men's 100-meter dash with a time of 9.83 seconds at the Tokyo Olympics semifinals. ()
- 5) These changes to the legislation are going to impact you more than most other

- revolutionary modifications. ()
- 6) Let's get some inside secrets from someone who worked as an insider in the new material industry. ()
- 7) There is a large body of evidence suggesting that Omicron is less likely to kill the people it infects. But can you imagine Omicron deaths exceeded delta's peak in the U.S. last Wednesday according to the *Wall Street Journal*? ()

CULTURAL NOTES

When crafting an introductory speech for an international conference, cultural aspects cannot be ignored because there is high possibility that the audience, the keynote speakers, the organizer, the sponsor and other participants tend to come from diverse cultural background. If you are going to introduce a Chinese presenter, it'll be wise to start with an old Chinese saying, a Chinese character you know, a Chinese city you once visited or a Chinese festival. That is, anything about China would be a nice try both for the keynote speaker, who may feel very welcomed, and for the audience, who can be motivated for the upcoming speech out of curiosity and interest. Cultural differences should also be considered for the sake of the audience. If the conference venue is located in an Arabic city, the audience is very likely to be composed basically of Muslims. On this occasion, funny stories or jokes about their life style or religion would be a total disaster. Factually it's a taboo throughout the introductory speech. Finally, discrimination against women, skin colour, obesity, the disabled or animals should definitely be avoided. Different people from different culture background have different perception about the above, and nothing can be taken for granted. For example, skin colour is a very common topic among Chinese and other east Asian women, which does not offend anyone. But it offends almost all coloured people in north America. *Male nurse* and *lady driver* are two so common noun phrases in China that most Chinese addressees would not feel discriminated, but it would be another story in Europe or America.

In summary, understanding cultural diversity should be part of the

preliminary research that we conduct before crafting an introductory speech, and we should also be aware that embracing differences with no judgement is the prerequisite to develop the vision for internationalization and a Community of Shared Future for Mankind.

LANGUAGE FOCUS

Language Features

1. Narrative language style

An easy way to write the script of the introduction would be to copy and paste from the biography of the keynote speaker. However, the style of an introductory presentation is very different from that of a biography. The presentation version:

- is much more listener-friendly, while biographies tend to be more formal and written;
- generally uses shorter sentences and is thus easier for the presenter to say;
- has fewer hard facts;
- has more interesting facts, or the facts that are presented in more audience related way;
- uses a narrative style.

2. The attention-getter

Like other presentations, introductory speech is also a presentation, where attention-getters are also necessary. Attention-getters are important in presentations because they can establish engagement from your audience before you share your message. An attention-getter for a presentation is a statement or question you can employ within the first few minutes. Often, speechwriters use these persuasive techniques to stimulate audiences' interest in their topic. Attention-getters mitigate the risk of the audiences' losing focus during long speeches, as they may generate enough interest at the beginning of the speech to captivate the audience throughout the statements that follow.

An audience may remember a successful attention-getter as an important part of your speech, so picking the right attention-getter is key. Here's a list of attention-getters that you can use at the beginning of an introductory speech to generate your audience's interest:

Table 2 Attention-getters and examples

Attention-getters	Examples
Humour	Good morning everyone. My name is Hu. Who? Hu.
Stories	When I was a kid, my favorite restaurant was Olive Garden.
Quote	As the saying goes, a man is known by the company he keeps.
Statistics	Do you realize in the past 3 minutes the rain forest of the size of 3 football fields in the Amazon disappeared?
Bold statements	If the low birth rate in South Korea persists, the whole country will not exist in 900 years.
Questions	Do you want to make money in the depression?
Analogies	Table tennis for Chinese people is football for American people.
Audience involvement	I believe this audience is the most intelligent people on the planet.

Useful Expressions

• Opening

- 1) I am delighted to make a few introductory remarks about our keynote speaker.
- 2) It is my pleasure to introduce today's speaker, Nancy Hunter Denney—a dynamic, high-energy educator, author, and business woman with a passion for life and leadership.

- 3) Now it's my privilege to introduce Ron Kilpatrick, General Manager of IBM Storage System Division.

• **The affiliation and the previous/current position of the speaker**

- 1) From 2011 to 2020, she was affiliated with the Institute for Social and Economic Policy in the Middle East at the Kennedy School of Harvard University.
- 2) Dr. Ken Lee is a Professor and the Chairperson of the Food Science and Technology Department at the Ohio State University in Columbus, Ohio.
- 3) Dr. Kizer is the president and the CEO of the new National Forum for Health Care Quality, Measurement and Reporting. And prior to this, he served as the undersecretary of Health in the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs, chief executive officer, the highest ranking physician in the federal government.

• **Education background**

- 1) Our speaker got her Ph.D. from Beijing University, Master's from Fudan university, and a nursing degree from Southeast University.
- 2) Six years of post-graduate study in natural health has led him to convey a unique understanding of health and nutrition. Graduating with honours, he has the formal training and experience to empower others with a straight-forward message of health and wellness.
- 3) Li holds a Bachelor of Science degree in communication. He also holds a Master of Business Administration in marketing from Nanjing University.

• **Academic achievements**

- 1) Dr. Klinov wrote extensively on the issues of immigration and refugees. Her papers from this period include compensation and rehabilitation of Arab refugees and the impact of the return of refugees to Palestine on the Jordanian economy.
- 2) Our speaker is the author of *Life by Design: A Do-It-Yourself Approach for Achieving Happiness* and served as the editor and co-author of *Let Your Leadership Speak: How to Lead and Be Heard*, recently released.
- 3) Our speaker is also co-author of three books and over fifty published articles. As a communication expert she has been quoted in the *Renmin Daily*, *China Daily*, and *Guangming Daily*.

• **Awards and honors**

- 1) Our speaker has had fellowships and grants from China National Natural Science Fund and China National Social Science Fund.
- 2) She is a Certified Speaking Professional—the highest earned designation bestowed by the National Speakers Association and held by less than 175 women nationwide.
- 3) Wang’s exceptional skills have earned him a place in the National Speakers Association Hall of Fame, an honour for platform excellence. He is also a member of the elite Speakers Roundtable, a group of 20 of the top speakers in east China.

• **Topic**

- 1) Today’s presentation is called “RSVP: How to Respond to Your Customers”, and our presenter, Cyndi Maxey, CSP, will show us how.
- 2) Now, let me present to you Professor James Bond, who will speak on the “Medical Applications of Nanotechnology”.
- 3) Please join me in welcoming our guest speaker today, whose topic is entitled “Human Rights in the 2020s: Seeing Through Both Eyes”, Li Ming.

• **Welcome**

- 1) Ladies and gentlemen, would you join me in welcoming our guest of honour and speaker today, Professor You Xiaohu.
- 2) Please help me give a dynamite welcome to distinguished psychologist Shu Hua.
- 3) If you would, please join me in giving a warm welcome to our keynote speaker, Chuck Martin.

Tasks

1. Translate the following sentences into English.

- 1) 很荣幸由我来介绍 Gordon Moore 博士, ISSCC 50 周年首位主旨发言人。

-
- 2) Moore 博士 1950 年本科 (BS) 毕业于加州大学伯克利分校化学专业。1954 年从加州理工学院获得化学和物理博士学位。

3) 现在请和我一起欢迎袁隆平院士给我们介绍他是如何用高产杂交水稻喂养全世界五分之一的人口。

4) 在钟南山 60 年的医生和教师生涯里,他以自己的专业和勇气完美诠释了医务工作者的初心和使命。

5) 作为亚洲飞人,苏炳添在东京奥运会半决赛中以 9.83 秒的成绩打破男子一百米的亚洲纪录,成为这个项目第一位晋级决赛的中国人。

2. The following passages are from two introductions of the same person.

Compare the two versions, and discuss the following two questions.

- 1) Which one is more suitable for an introductory speech?
- 2) What are the differences in language features between the two versions?

Version 1	Version 2
The period of the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics (1922 – 1991) provided ample opportunities for women to enter higher education in all fields and sectors, including natural or physical sciences (e.g., chemistry, biology, physics, or astronomy). In 1985 the number of female undergraduate students stood at 40%, with 10% undertaking a doctorate.	In the Soviet period, women were able to get into higher education in all fields, including hard sciences, in a way that was unimaginable in Western Europe. In 1985, six years before the breakup of the USSR, the number of female students was 40%. What is changing in the post-Soviet period is the feminization

continued

Version 1	Version 2
The post-Soviet period is witnessing a so-called feminization of science, in which there has been an emigration of highly trained or qualified scientists. Notable individuals who decided to leave Russia include Pavel Durov (the founder of VKontakte Russia's version of Facebook), and the economist Sergei Guriev. In contrast, female Russian scientists have remained in Russia and the number of female researchers in such underrepresented areas of sciences as physics, maths, and life sciences has shown a marked tendency to increase.	of science. There has been a brain drain with male researchers going abroad. And it's not just the academics who leave. Chessmaster Garry Kasparov left in 2013. He was followed the next year by the founder of Russia's version of Facebook. But the women tend to stick with the motherland. Consequently, the number of female researchers in previously underrepresented areas of sciences such as physics, maths, and the life sciences is growing.

3. Study the following introduction which needs revision and work on the following two tasks.

- 1) Discuss why it needs revision.
- 2) Rewrite this section based on the discussion and what you have learnt.

Ladies and gentlemen, I'd like to introduce our guest speaker Stan Smith. Stan is going to talk about the project, and in particular the factor which he thinks has been the most important to our success: hard work. I agree with Stan. What I think is most important about hard work is that no-one gets anywhere without hard graft. I mean, look at all the training those Olympic gold medalists have to go through. Without further ado then, over to you, Stan.

- 4. The world-famous physicist Professor Yang is invited to Southeast University for her 120th anniversary to give a keynote speech entitled Higher Education in China in The Next Decade at the Postgraduate Forum. Attendees are SEU students of all levels, faculty and alumni. Write an introduction of Dr. Yang based on the following two biographies from the official website of Tsinghua University for this conference. You can also search relative information on other websites.**

Biography 1

Professor Yang was born on September 22, 1922, in Hofei, Anwhei, China, the first of five children of Ke Chuan Yang and Meng Hwa Loh Yang. He is also known as Frank or Franklin.

Yang was brought up in the peaceful and academically inclined atmosphere of the campus of Tsinghua University, just outside of Peiping, China, where his father was a Professor of Mathematics. He received his college education at the National Southwest Associated University in Kunming, China, and completed his B.Sc. degree there in 1942. His M.Sc. degree was received in 1944 from Tsinghua University, which had moved to Kunming during the Chinese War of Resistance Against Japanese Aggression (1937-1945). He went to the U.S.A. at the end of the war on a Tsinghua University Fellowship, and entered the University of Chicago in January 1946. At Chicago he came under the strong influence of Professor E. Fermi. After receiving his Ph.D. degree in 1948, Yang served for a year at the University of Chicago as an Instructor.

Yang has worked on various subjects in physics, but has his chief interest in two fields: statistical mechanics and symmetry principles. His Ph.D. thesis "On the Angular Distribution in Nuclear Reactions and Coincidence Measurements", written under the guidance of Professor E. Teller, was instrumental in introducing him to these fields.

Dr. Yang is a prolific author, his numerous articles appearing in the Bulletin of the American Mathematical Society, *Physical Review*, *Reviews of Modern Physics*, and *Chinese Journal of Physics*.

(<https://www.tsinghua.edu.cn/en/info/1244/2414.htm>)

Biography 2

Present positions:

Albert Einstein Professor of Physics, State University of New York at Stony Brook, USA, 1966 to 1999, Emeritus 1999-

Distinguished Professor-at-large, Chinese University of Hong Kong, 1986-
Professor, Tsinghua University, Beijing, PRC, 1998-

Awards:

Nobel Prize-1957

Membership/Foreign Membership in:

U. S. Academy of Sciences

Chinese Academy of Sciences, Beijing

Chairman of:

Div. of Particles and Fields of the American Physical Society-1970-71

Fachbeirat of the Max Planck Institute of Physics, Munich-1980-83

President of:

Asia Pacific Center of Theoretical Physics (APCTP)-1996-

Member of:

Board of Directors of the Neuroscience Institute-1983-1988

Board of Directors of the Scientific American Inc.-1983-1990

Lectureships:

Loeb Lecturer, Harvard University (1957, 1972 and 1997)

Wu-Zhi Yang Lecturer, Fudan University, Shanghai

(<https://www.tsinghua.edu.cn/en/info/1244/2414.htm>)

PROJECT

Write an introductory speech for the keynote speaker invited to your group conference in the following suggested steps.

Step 1 Study the CV or introduction on the official website of the speakers' affiliation.

Step 2 Use the searching engine to collect information of the speakers' previous presentations, news reports, documentaries and even

anecdotes.

Step 3 Analyze the audience in terms of the size, their needs, cultural and education background.

Step 4 Link the subject and/or the speaker to the audience.

Step 5 Customize an introduction script based on the information you have collected.

Step 6 Rehearse until you are fluent enough in what you are going to talk about.

CHECKLIST

☐	Know the speaker's name and how to pronounce it.
☐	Know the speaker's title or position.
☐	Be brief. Aim for between one and three minutes.
☐	Do not read the introduction.
☐	Smile and be enthusiastic in tone, gesture and choice of words.
☐	Know enough about the subject to sound knowledgeable.
☐	Announce the speech title as given to you by the speaker.
☐	Introductions are no place to use slides, overheads or presentation software.
☐	Anecdotes are good but should pertain to the subject and be in harmony with the mood of the presentation.
☐	Introduction of a panel of speakers is the same except the introducer needs to describe the structure and format of the panel (speaking order, length of time).
☐	Never use the old cliché that the speaker needs no introduction.
☐	Do not try to upstage the speaker with your knowledge of the subject.
☐	Identify yourself by name and title, unless this has already been earlier.

Unit 7

Keynote Speeches

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To be aware of the importance of a keynote speech;
- To understand the structure of a keynote speech;
- To know the strategies and skills to revise an academic paper into a keynote speech;
- To present a keynote speech with the appropriate style and expressions.



STRUCTURE

A keynote speech, also known as a keynote address, is a kind of speech designed to present the issues of primary interest to an assembly, such as an academic convention. It sets the tone for the conference and motivate the audience.

Usually, the organizers of an academic conference invite as the keynote speakers either those who are influential and experienced specialists in the field, or those who have made contributions to the field. The speakers are designated to deliver a speech at the plenary sessions or keynote sessions, which can highlight the theme and the essence of the conference or reveal the latest development of the field.

As you begin preparation, consider your future audience and the disciplinary concerns of the conference. If you are presenting a paper on a topic that your audience may not be familiar with, think about putting some foundational background information in your paper before you get too focused. Adding context or a summary of previous research may be helpful tactics. Look back at the call for papers and ask yourself both what the concerns of the conference are, as well as the concerns of your field. Being able to contextualize your research within the larger disciplinary field is essential for a successful conference paper.

Before Drafting the Keynote Speech

If you are invited to be a keynote speaker, it is really a good chance to show your standing in the academic community and bring credit to your institution. But crafting an effective keynote speech is challenging. A good keynote speech must be gripping and inspiring. Here are some tips you can follow before drafting the speech.

- **Determine the purpose of the speech.** Often the main purpose of a keynote speech is to explore or reinforce the theme of the conference. As a keynote speaker, you need to have knowledge about the theme that you can share in the keynote. So when you begin preparation, consider the disciplinary concerns of the conference. You can look at the call for papers and try to

integrate the concerns of the conference and the concerns of your field.

- **Know your audience.** Think about their background and their level of expertise. Then tailor the speech to suit the audience, both terms of ideas and language. If they are scholars sharing the similar academic interests with you, you can surely use more specialized language. If you are presenting a paper on a topic that your audience may not be familiar with, put some foundational background information in your speech before you get too focused and use plain language instead of specialized terms.
- **Decide on the length and the structure.** Your writing process will be much easier if you keep your eye on your target length. Ask the organizer of the conference how long your speech will last. More often than not, you need to revise your paper to suit the time limit. So concentrate on the main points and hammer home the essence of your argument. Usually the structure involves around three segments: Introduction, Body, and Conclusion.

Writing the Keynote Speech

Then, you can begin to write your speech. First and foremost, outline your speech. You need to develop an outline of the structure of your speech and consider the main ideas for each section. A clearly defined structure enables the audience to follow along easily and understand what you talk about. Often you can break down what you have to say into three segments: Introduction, Body and Conclusion.

A. Begin with a compelling introduction

Usually the Introduction defines key terms, situates the paper's topic within the context of your discipline and the conference, and briefly sums up what you're going to talk about. Apart from that, you need to think carefully about how to engage the audience from the very beginning of the speech. A great speech always has a good start. Not only will this gain attention but it may also motivate your audience to listen. To begin your speech, you could present a relevant fact or an engaging topical issue in the field; you could start with a decent joke or an interesting quote; you could also use a fact from your own research,

or look at some current event that relates to the purpose of your speech. For a good Introduction, remember:

- to stick to the theme of your speech;
- to make it relevant to the conference;
- to add your own little touch to it and avoid being too generic;
- not to make it too lengthy;
- to use transitions to link the Introduction to the Body.

In academic speaking, the purpose of the Introduction is to tell your audience what you are doing in your speech, why you are doing it and how you are doing it. So the following three steps can help you achieve that purpose.

Step 1 Establish a research territory by indicating the importance of the general research area, or by introducing and reviewing previous research in the area. For example:

1) *Recently, there has been growing interest in urbanization in European countries.*

2) *Many researchers have extensively studied juvenile delinquency in recent years.*

Step 2 Establish a niche by revealing a gap in previous research and raising a question about it. For example:

1) *However, there is little information/data/research on the negative effects of urbanization on the development of rural areas.*

2) *Although considerable research has been devoted to juvenile delinquency, rather less attention has been paid to the prevention measures adopted by the community.*

Step 3 Occupy the niche by stating the purposes or the nature of the present research, and also showing the structure of the speech. For example:

1) *In this talk, I would like to concentrate on the blockchain-based networks.*

2) *This subject can be looked at under the following headings.*

B. Offer a body of evidence

This is the heart of your keynote speech and the part where you deliver your

entire speech and explain your ideas. The body of your speech is where you hit them with the facts, quotes, and evidence to back up your main points.

- **Present your thesis and supporting material in a simple and organized way.** Don't try to share absolutely everything you know on your topic, instead center upon the key points. Stick to one point at a time and finish the thought before you move on to the next. Build in clear and logical transitions from idea to idea. Link them together to make sure each flows in a smooth, logical progression.
- **Put your strongest points first, from most to least important.** Sometimes, time constraints will force you to cut short a speech, but it will be easier to cut from the bottom than the other way around. Always include relevant examples, quotes and statistics to support each main point that you make.
- **Repeat key terms and words.** Repetition can reinforce your ideas and remind the audience of the key points. Bring up a point made earlier in the speech, thus the audience is reminded of the purpose of your speech.
- **Be humorous.** Humour is a great tool in a keynote speech. Being funny can help make your speech memorable. You can adopt a light tone, but remember to have a balance of funny asides and serious moments.
- **Write the speech in your natural voice.** It is true that a keynote speech in an academic context is somewhat professional, but never put on the formal tone employed for academic writing. It means that you must write the paper again if your speech is based on one of your papers. Written language is different from spoken language. You need to change the language style when rewriting your paper.

In order to make arguments more convincing, it is often useful to include reference to tables and charts, which can be shown on PPT slides. When you refer to a diagram, you can say like these:

- 1) *The table here shows the demand for electricity in France during typical days in winter and summer.*
- 2) *As we can see in this chart, the overall proportion of heart-related hospital admissions in the United States attributable to patients aged 35 – 54 steadily climbed from 27 percent to 32 percent in recent years, with the*

largest increase observed in young women.

When describing the tables and charts, you often need to make comparison and contrast, speaking about the similarities and differences. For example:

- 1) *We compared three personal computers, Model A, Model B and Model C, with respect to three factors: price, screen size and processor speed.*
- 2) *As the table shows, Model A is similar to Model B with respect to processor speed.*
- 3) *Model B costs \$1,299, in contrast to Model C, which costs \$2,499.*

C. Sum up with key takeaways

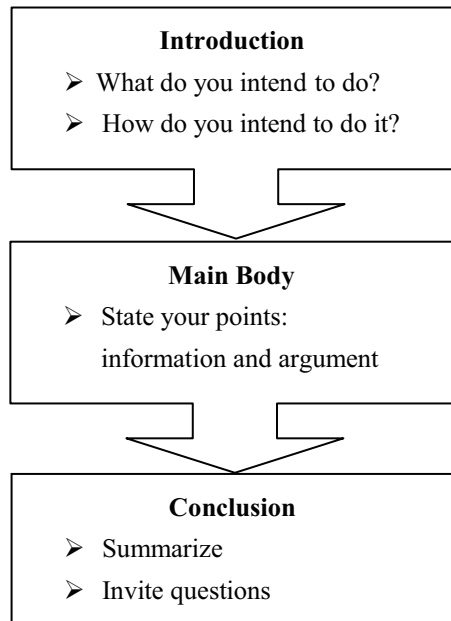
A good keynote speech must have some takeaways, which the audience can engage with. The Conclusion is where you loop back to your original statement and give the audience these key takeaways. Wrap everything up and drive your main theme home by summarizing what you have just said and providing the deal-clinching argument. This is the final opportunity to convince your audience, and never leave an audience hanging. Also you can provide something they will be left thinking after your keynote speech.

Remember to use signal words indicating that you are going to end the speech, and then restate your key points to impress your audience. For example:

- 1) *So we've seen that water-related problems continue to affect millions of people and, contrary to what most people believe, future water supplies will not last for ever.*
- 2) *In conclusion, it is certainly true that the twentieth century gave us some advantages by, for example, making us richer, healthier and freer to enjoy our lives. However, in our opinion, it did not make us wiser.*

And for most conferences, the keynote session usually ends with Question & Answer. After summarizing what you have said, invite questions directly and politely. Sometimes the session chair will announce the beginning Q&A and invite the questions from the audience. Please see Unit 8 for the skills and strategies for dealing with Q&A.

The following chart illustrates the three segments of a typical keynote speech.



Polishing the Keynote Speech

After you finish the first draft of your speech, you need to edit and polish what you have written. Another necessary step is practice, practice and practice. The more you practice your speech, the more you will discover which segments need reworked, which transitions should be improved, and which sentences are hard to say. You will also find out how you are doing on length. So update, practice, and revise your speech until it has a great flow and you feel it is ready to accomplish its purpose.

- **Read the speech aloud.** Once you have a draft of the speech completed, take the time to read the speech aloud to yourself and to others. Check the flow of material and the suitability of language. Notice if there are any awkward sentences or sections. Adjust them so the speech sounds natural and polished. If you read the speech aloud to others, you can ask them for feedback. Ask them if they found any parts of the speech boring or hard to follow. Be open to getting constructive feedback on the speech so it is at its best.
- **Proofread the speech.** Make sure the spelling, grammar, and punctuation in the speech is correct. Try reading the speech to confirm each word is spelled correctly. Circle all the punctuation and confirm it is correct. Correct

punctuation is especially important if you are going to read the speech aloud to an audience, as the punctuation will tell you when to pause or take a breath. Often, a comma means pausing in your speech and a period means taking a short breath.

- **Revise the speech for clarity, brevity and length.** You should also look over the speech to make sure each section is clear and easy to follow. Often, shorter is better so if there are any wordy or overly long sections, try to make them shorter. Look for any words or terms you do not need. If there is a time constraint for the speech, you should also time yourself reading the speech to confirm it is within the limit.

Sample Analysis

National Digital Conference 2015: Keynote Speech

Matthew Hancock spoke about simplicity, iteration and transformation in government services at the National Digital Conference 2015.

Keynote Speech	Elements
Almost everyone, almost everywhere, carries with them one of the most profound <i>symbols of digital transformation</i> the world has ever seen. <i>I'd bet a large sum you've got one on you.</i> That everyone reading this has one on them. And that if you're reading it online, you're probably using it right now. The smartphone! <i>In my lifetime this didn't exist.</i> Ten years ago it was a communications device. Today it's an office in miniature, a London A to Z, an entertainment centre, a digital camera, a fitness monitor—for some of my younger officials, it's a dating agency—and hundreds of other things besides.	Begin with a compelling introduction. • Stick to the theme of your speech. • Be humorous. • Add your own little touch to it and avoid being too generic.

continued

Keynote Speech	Elements
<i>And one of the biggest questions for government today is, how do we use that technology to govern better? How do we drive digital in government to improve the lives and the finances of millions? There isn't a playbook for this, so over the last 5 years we've had to innovate and experiment, seeing what works and what doesn't.</i> <i>Today I want to set out some guiding principles based on the lessons that have been learned.</i> Simplicity <i>The first principle is simplicity. I can't stress this enough: Simplicity is the end; digital is just the means. The point of using complex technology is not to make things more complex, but to make them easier: for the public, for frontline staff and for government itself. For the public, when government services are on paper they're almost inevitably designed for the demands of the machine, rather than the needs of individual users. If you want to access a service, you have to fill out a form. Many of the questions aren't aimed at you, but at the small minority who want to exploit the system. Yet everyone has to plough through them. Yet in a digital world we're much better placed to understand and detect those problems.</i>	• Make it relevant to the conference. • Don't make it too lengthy. • Use signaling statements. Offer a body of evidence. • Present your points in a simple and organized way; use signaling statements.

continued

Keynote Speech	Elements
<i>Omitted.</i> There are around 700 interactions between government and citizen, many of which could be digitized. Yet one of the biggest barriers to wide-spread adoption of digital services is that it's time-consuming and expensive for departments to build the underlying infrastructure. That's what "Government as a platform" is designed to tackle. We are building a common set of platforms, core digital plumbing which can be used by services across government. <i>For example</i>, almost every part of government maintains a separate system for making and taking payments, often from the same people. A common payments platform can help integrate services while saving money. A common platform has the potential to give better service at a lower cost. It makes life simpler for public servants too, freeing them to focus on what really matters: delivering their core service. And with common platforms it's not just that we bring new services online quicker, we can also rebuild them quicker if they're not working out as planned, <i>which brings me onto my second principle: iteration.</i> Iteration Iteration is the opposite of the big bang model of policymaking. We've all seen it. The	• Include relevant examples. • Use signaling statements.

continued

Keynote Speech	Elements
big announcement, the big contract for “big IT”, the endless delays, the grand launch, etc. Iteration is all about small. Small teams of developers taking small steps: getting a small prototype out quickly and cheaply, watching to see how people actually use it, then incrementally improving the design. Rinse and repeat. Rinse and repeat. Iteration means basing decisions as much as possible on observation, not prediction. <i>Come with me to Helsinki for a moment.</i> In Finland, town planners will visit a local park immediately after a snowfall, because the footprints reveal the paths that people naturally choose to take. These “desire paths” are then paved over the following summer. We too must <i>pave the paths</i> people travel. How? Let’s take a small example. People search for “pay council tax”, but they don’t usually say where they live. We’ve <i>paved the path</i> so you’re taken from GOV.UK to the relevant page of your local council website in just one click. And it’s not just about making websites more user-friendly. As we adopt this approach more widely we will transition from a target culture, where ministers try and manage services from on high, to a data culture, where services adjust in response to user-feedback. <i>Omitted.</i> Now paving the path like this might sound	• Write the speech in your natural voice. • Repeat key terms and words.

continued

Keynote Speech	Elements
like we're resigned to marginal improvement. No. Our ultimate goal is not just to improve, but to transform. To get how people actually behave in real life; not just change the technology but transform the whole business model. <i>So my final principle is transformation.</i> Transformation It's been a long time coming. We've had a paper-based government since around the 12th century. And to this day we continue to operate on paper foundations. The 19th century structures we've inherited reflect the fact that decision-makers and information needed to be in the same place. Paper files, which could only be moved around on trolleys, had to be within easy reach. This has led to silos, to information hoarding, and to people with complex needs getting lost between the cracks. I suppose it was better than the vellum that came before. But now, for the first time, we are in a position to build digital foundations; made of data not paper, holding up platforms not silos. Common registers, common payments platforms, and common licence systems, all based on common data standards. This digital infrastructure is the modern equivalent of the canals and railways that made industrialization possible. And once it's established	• Use transitions and signaling statements.

continued

Keynote Speech	Elements
we can build platforms on top: integrated public services with the citizen at their heart. <i>Omitted.</i> This is our chance to build a new state, crafted around the needs of the users. Using the best and most innovative technology to cut costs and improve services. Not the all-encompassing state of the 20th century, but a state you can hold in the palm of your hand. And as if to show that the onward march never ceases, the symbol of transformation is no longer the iPhone in your hand, but here, miniaturized in the iWatch on your wrist. These are exciting times. Technology marches on and makes things much easier. And we who see the transformative power of technology, we who would pave the path people travel: we have work to do.	Sum up with key takeaways.

Tasks

1. Complete the following “The Quick How to Write a Keynote Speech Checklist” with what you have learned in the text.

The Quick How to Write a Keynote Speech Checklist
Before drafting the speech, you need to know: ☐ 1) you are preparing this speech (the purpose). ☐ 2) you are speaking to (the target audience).

☐ 3) your speech is going to be about (the topic & key points).

☐ 4) time you have for this speech.

The basic format of your speech:

Part 1 A compelling opening or introduction to 5).

Part 2 The body presenting 6).

Part 3 An ending with 7).

How to write your speech:

☐ Write your main ideas out and present them in 8).

☐ Put the strongest points first, and use 9) to support them.

☐ Repeat key terms and words to 10).

☐ Be humorous, but be careful to have a balance between 11).

☐ Write in your natural voice.

After finishing the draft of your speech:

☐ Read the speech aloud and get feedback to make your speech 12).

☐ Proofread the speech to make sure the accuracy of 13).

☐ Revise the speech for 14).

2. Read the above sample script, and discuss the following questions.

1) How did the speaker start the speech?

2) How did the speaker end the speech?

CULTURAL NOTES

It is inevitable to use information from an outside source. No matter you are writing a paper, or drafting a speech, always remember to give credit to that source. In academic speaking you are responsible for demonstrating the sources of the information. That is to say, if you use someone else's ideas, or findings of

other scholars' researches, don't forget to mention the sources in the speech. What's more, always remember to follow quotes, references to someone else's ideas, data not collected by yourself, or graphs not designed by yourself on the PPT slides with a citation.

If you use someone else's ideas or language without acknowledging that you did not create them, it is plagiarism, which is really serious in the academic world. Whenever you include another person's information or wording in a document, either a speech script or a PPT slide, you must acknowledge the source and include a citation that will tell your readers or audience where you obtained it. Otherwise you are guilty of plagiarism.

LANGUAGE FOCUS

Language Features

Academic spoken style, which a keynote speech for an academic conference should apply, is similar in many ways to academic writing style: It is formal, explicit, hedged, and responsible. However, it is less complex and objective than written language.

1. Formality

Although academic spoken English is less formal than academic written English, in general in a formal academic presentation, such as a keynote speech, you need to avoid:

- colloquial words and expressions, such as *stuff*, *a lot of*, *thing*, *kind of*, *sort of*.
- two-word verbs, such as *put off*, *bring forth*, *pick up*.

2. Complexity

Surely, spoken language is less complex than written language. Spoken texts are longer with more repetition and the language has shorter words. It is lexically less dense and it has a less varied vocabulary. Usually it is comparatively more fragmented with more simple sentences and more use of coordination, such as *and*, *but*, *so*, *because* rather than embedded subordination. Besides, spoken

language has more active verbs than written language. In formal written English, we often use a passive when we do not want to specify who the agent is. But in spoken English, more active verbs are used and we use *people*, *somebody*, *they*, *we*, *you* as the subject.

Here are some examples indicating the differences between academic written language and academic spoken language.

Academic written	Academic spoken
• A detailed study of personnel and associated costs has been carried out. • The use of this method unquestionably leads to safer and faster train running in the most adverse weather conditions. • Improvements in technology have reduced the risks and high costs associated with simultaneous installation.	• We have carried out a detailed study of personnel and the cost associated to it. • If this method of control is used, trains will be able to run more safely and faster even when the weather conditions are most adverse. • Because the technology has improved, it's less risky than it used to be when you install them at the same time, and it doesn't cost so much either.

Academic spoken language is well-planned, formal compared with the usual spoken language used in daily life, and informal compared with academic written language. If you are going to present your paper at an academic conference, or you are invited as a keynote speaker, you need to change your paper into academic spoken style.

Useful Expressions

• Introduction: Stating what you will say

1) Today, I'm going to talk about ...

- 2) What I'd like to do is to discuss/explain ...
 - 3) In this talk, I would like to concentrate on ...
 - 4) The subject/purpose of this talk is ...
- **Introduction: Stating how you will say it**
 - 1) I'm going to deal with three aspects of the subject.
 - 2) I've divided my presentation into three sections.
 - 3) The talk should last about 30 minutes.
 - 4) I'll be happy to answer questions at the end.
 - **Body: Referring back to what you have said**
 - 1) As I said at the beginning, ...
 - 2) In the first part of my talk, I said ...
 - 3) As I mentioned earlier, ...
 - **Body: Putting it in other words**
 - 1) Let me put it another way.
 - 2) To put it another way, ...
 - 3) The point I'm making is ...
 - 4) What I'm suggesting is ...
 - **Body: Using visuals**
 - 1) Take a look at this.
 - 2) I'd like to draw your attention to ...
 - 3) As you can see from the diagram, ...
 - 4) As the figures indicate, ...
 - 5) If you look closely, you'll see ...
 - **Body: Moving on**
 - 1) I'd like now to move on to ...
 - 2) Having looked at ..., I'd now like to consider ...
 - 3) Now, let's turn to ...
 - **Conclusion: Concluding**
 - 1) In brief, we have looked at ...
 - 2) In conclusion, I'd like to emphasize that ...
 - 3) That completes my presentation.
 - **Conclusion: Inviting questions**
 - 1) That covers the main points. If you have any comments or questions, I'll

be happy to hear them.

- 2) So that explains my main point. Does anyone have any comments or questions?
- 3) I'd be glad to try and answer any questions.

Tasks

1. Translate the following sentences into English.

- 1) 今天我要和大家说的是区块链的应用,这是本次大会的主题,也是我近期的学术工作主题。

- 2) 正如您在这张曲线图上看到的,MA2001 在今年 1—4 月份的产量稳定在每月 5000 左右。

- 3) 正如之前我所提到的,随着在线教育持续增长,许多高校在积极探索如何向线上学习者提供课程内容。

- 4) 看完了有关市场的供求问题,接下来我想谈一谈商业投资。

- 5) 最后,我想强调,既然水的问题已经影响到我们每个人,而且目前不少措施见效较为缓慢,所以我们认为只有节约用水、控制污染,这一问题才能最终解决。

2. The following is the beginning of an academic paper. Change the text into more natural spoken English as part of the Introduction in an academic keynote speech.

You can start like this: *Today I'd like to talk about ...*

Introduction

The subject of this paper is a cost-benefit analysis of introducing job-sharing. The aim is to provide the necessary information for a decision to be made within the next two months. The subject will be looked at under the following headings; financial implications, working practices, and social effects.

3. Select a published paper from a journal article in your field and try to turn it into a keynote speech. You can use the following template to draft your speech. Then deliver the speech in class.

Keynote Speech Outline Template

Title :

I. Introduction

A. Attention-getter ;

B. Thesis Statement ;

C. Preview Statements: First we will ...

Second we will ...

And finally we will ...

Transition Statement ;

II. Body

A. Main Point 1 ;

Evidence ;

B. Main Point 2 ;

Evidence ;

C. Main Point 3 ;

Evidence ;

Transition Statement ;

III. Conclusion

A. Summary of Main Points ;

B. Key Takeaways ;

PROJECT

Write a keynote speech/keynote speeches for your group conference in the following suggested steps.

- Step 1** Determine the theme of the conference and the purpose of the speech.
- Step 2** Decide on main points, the structure and the length of the speech.
- Step 3** Think about how to start the speech.
- Step 4** Offer evidence to back up the main points.
- Step 5** Write the speech in the natural voice.
- Step 6** Summarize the key takeaways to end the speech.
- Step 7** Take the time to read the speech aloud.
- Step 8** Adjust some awkward sentences and sections to make the speech sound natural and polished.
- Step 9** Revise the speech for clarity and length.
- Step 10** Design PPT slides based on the script.
- Step 11** Proofread the texts on PPT slides.
- Step 12** Practice and rehearse the speech.

CHECKLIST

☐	The objective of your speech is clear.
☐	Know your audience well.
☐	The content is well-chosen and related to the theme of the conference.
☐	Know the time limit for your speech.
☐	Change the language style of an academic paper into academic spoken English.
☐	The speech has a clear and logical structure.

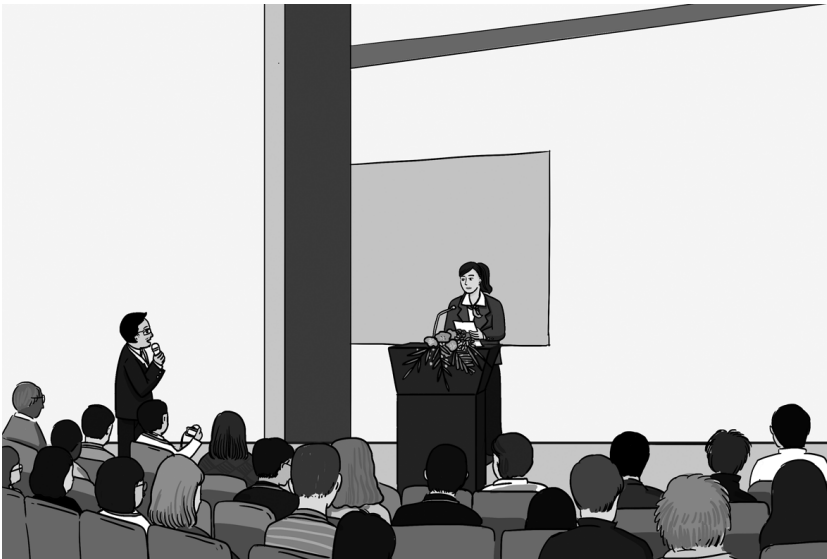
☐	Begin your speech with a compelling introduction.
☐	State and explain your ideas with facts, quotes, and evidence in the body.
☐	Sum up with key takeaways in the end of your speech.
☐	Read the speech aloud to practice when the draft is completed.
☐	Proofread the speech.
☐	Revise the speech for clarity, brevity and length.

Unit 8

Question and Answer Session

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To understand the importance of the Question and Answer Session;
- To know the skills and strategies for handling the Question and Answer session;
- To be able to raise questions in a Question and Answer session;
- To be able to answer questions in a Question and Answer session.



GUIDELINES

After giving a keynote speech, the presenter will be called upon to answer questions from the audience. This session is called Question and Answer session, or Q&A session.

Why do most keynotes end with a Q&A session? It is a short but crucial part. As we know, most conferences leave the audience in “listening mode” most of the time. A Q&A session can make perfect sense to give the listeners a voice, allowing for some unscripted interaction with the presenters. The listeners get a chance to clarify parts of the speech and ask the presenter to expand on interesting topics. The answers may be the most memorable parts of the speech. But a badly handled Q&A session will be disappointing to the listeners or even embarrassing to the presenters.

For Presenters

In a live Q&A session, the presenters never know what they are going to get. So this session is quite intimidating and challenging for most presenters. They need to make preparations for that. If they have thoroughly researched their topic and have anticipated the types of questions they may receive, they will be better able to handle the Q&A session. Here are some guidelines for handling Q&A sessions:

- **Think about possible questions in advance.** Give yourself some quality time to consider how you'll answer them. It will give you the chance to practice giving clear succinct answers. Remember to keep answers short and to the point.
- **Declare the Q&A session in advance.** Usually the presenters will tell the audience that they plan to do a Q&A at the start of the speech. Thus, you are planting the thought in the audience's minds and giving them time to think up questions. In addition, set some ground rules before you start the Q&A. For example, waiting for the microphone before asking the question, introducing

oneself (usually by name and organization), etc. These rules can give the session a structure and help to keep control of the audience. For example:

- 1) *We will have 15 minutes for an open discussion at the end of the speech, but each person can ask only one question.*
- 2) *I'd appreciate it if you can hold your questions till the end of the presentation.*

- **Make sure you understand the question.** Always paraphrase it for the inquirer to check for understanding. Another benefit of paraphrase is for those who may not have heard the question. Since the presenter doesn't have time to think about the answer, paraphrasing the question can also buy a little time for the presenter. Of course, if you did not understand the question, just ask for clarification. For example:

- 1) **Paraphrasing:** *Are you asking what leads to our estimation that the Engel's coefficient will decline in the following 6 months?*
- 2) **Asking for clarification:** *I don't understand what you mean by total package.*

- **Keep the audience on the topic.** If the inquirer asks a question which is not related to the topic of your speech, you can dismiss it directly, but friendly. If you don't have answer, tell them so or volunteer to find out the information and provide the answer at a later time. For example:

- 1) *I really appreciate your concern over the inflation issue, but today's focus is on investment policies.*
- 2) *I did not hear Prof. Smith's remarks about eliminating unions. I will check the minutes from that meeting and address this issue at the seminar to be held tomorrow.*

- **Answer directly and succinctly, and stick to time.** Tell the audience what you know, why you believe it, or what you believe, and keep it brief and to the point. Nobody wants to listen to another speech. Sometimes the Q&A session ends up like a vacuum of time that needs to be filled; sometimes, there is a stream of questions that never seems to stop. The second issue can cause the Q&A session to run widely overtime. If possible, use a stop clock so you can see how much time you have left. This will also enable you to keep

answers succinct and tell the audience in advance that you only have, i.e., 5 minutes left so can only take two more questions from the floor.

- **Know how to reestablish your point and don't get into a debate.** Regard the Q&A session as another chance to reinforce your points. Try to integrate them into your answer. If someone is being persistent in their questioning, then offer to speak to them after the session in person. Never engage in a heated argument in front of the audience. No one wants to be a spectator to a lengthy debate. Your goal is to maintain control of the session and goodwill with the audience.

Remember to look at the questioners and listen to them attentively while they are asking questions. When you answer the question, you need to present it to the audience as a whole. After answering, check with the questioner to determine whether you have answered the question to their satisfaction. For example:

- 1) *Did I address your concerns?*
- 2) *Did I answer your question?*

For Questioners

The Q&A session is an opportunity for the listeners to interact with the presenter. Before raising questions, **make remarks and comments first**. Usually it is a polite way to show that you are listening to the speech. For example:

- 1) *Mr. Bush, your speech is really wonderful. And the findings of your research are very impressive and meaningful. And may I ask you a question about ...*
- 2) *Prof. Edward, you shared your latest findings in the speech, which, in my eyes, are breakthroughs in this field. And here, I have a question about ...*

Then, you can raise questions. According to the motivation and purposes, the questions could be classified into different types.

- You can ask the presenter to **clarify the points** that you have not quite understood, or the points that have not been fully illustrated, or you can ask for

more relevant information. For example:

- 1) *Prof. Hanks, I don't quite understand what you mean by saying "all the factors are correlated." Could you please explain it by giving us some examples?*
 - 2) *I would like to ask you a question. In your speech, you mentioned "the peak value". Is it possible to share with us some statistical information about it?*
- You may also raise questions to **show your special interests** in certain points mentioned in the speech. Usually, the purpose of these questions is to learn more about a particular aspect, or to have a deeper understanding of a concept close to your own researches. For example:
 - 1) *I'm keen on the theoretical aspects of the project. Now would you please say a few more words about the theoretical framework of your research?*
 - 2) *The research I'm going to start has some connections with yours. So I'm very interested in how you carry out the research in your laboratory.*
 - Sometimes, you may **raise different opinions** in Q&A sessions, since scientific research tends to result in different conclusions and opinions. For example:
 - 1) *Mr. Taylor, the hypothesis you mentioned in the last part is really impressive. But as far as the approaches proving it is concerned, I'm afraid I can't say I go along with you on that. Could you please give us further explanation about that?*
 - 2) *The first point you mentioned is something related to the subject I've been studied. And I'd say I've got some sidelights from your views. Maybe more variables need to be considered. Can I have your comments on that?*

Sample Analysis

Professor Nan Li is giving a keynote speech at 2022 International Conference of Second Language Acquisition, Beijing.

Q&A	Elements
Prof. Li: All right, that's all for my presentation. We have 15 minutes for the discussion. Any question is welcome. Host: Yes. The gentleman in black in the first row, please. Questioner A: Thank you so much for your speech. I'm Li Hua, a first-year graduate student from Beijing University. You mentioned in the third slide that learners of lower Age of Acquisition have more and better L2 input. Besides AOA, is there any other factor that contributes to the quantity and quality of L2 input? Prof. Li: Thank you, Hua, for your question. But one thing I should make clear is that we are talking about naturalist settings, not the classroom settings. My answer is yes, there are many other factors contributing to L2 acquisition of kids, for example, language environment, aptitude. Did I answer your question? Questioner A: Sure. Thank you, Professor. Host: The lady in white in the second row, please.	Presenter: Inviting questions Questioner: • Thanking the presenter • Self-introduction Presenter: • Thanking the questioner • Positive closure to each exchange

continued

Q&A	Elements
Questioner B :I'm Zhang Lin , a university teacher from Southwest University , China. On the first review slide, the re-search showed that Mandarin Tone 2 and Tone 3 are difficult for English speakers and Cantonese speakers even though Cantonese is also a tonal language. However, I know that there is a Tone 3 change rule in spoken Mandarin, which is when two or more than two Tone 3 characters get together, only the last Tone 3 keeps the original tone, and others should be pronounced as Tone 2. So I wonder if native Man-darin speakers also have difficulties in Tone 3. If this is the case, I doubt whether Tone 3, which is difficult for even Mandarin spea-kers to produce accurately, can be used to distinguish between native Mandarin speakers and non-native Mandarin speakers.	

continued

Q&A	Elements
Professor Li: Thank you, Professor Zhang. But are you asking if mandarin speakers have difficulty in pronouncing Tone 3, and if Tone 3 can be an indicator to differentiate Mandarin speakers of different levels? Questioner B: Yes, that’s what I mean. Professor Li: OK. These are factually two questions. I’m sorry I don’t have a definite answer for you, as I haven’t done the research or read the relative literature. You can design some experiments to test your hypotheses. Host: Any other question? Oh, yes. Questioner C: Good morning, Professor Li. I’m James Bond from University of Maryland, USA. I’m so much impressed by your introduction of Flege’s model. According to Flege, adults have the same capacity in developing native-like phonology in an L2 as children learning their first language. I wonder how adults overcome the declination of neural flexibility and L1 entrenchment? And how should we define “sameness” in his assumption?	Presenter: • Positive feedback to questions

continued

Q&A	Elements
Prof. Li; I totally understand what you mean. We cannot prove it yet as far as I know, also it's counter intuitive, right? Host: We are running out of time. We have to stop here and have a coffee break. After that, we'll proceed to the next session.	

Similar to other conversational settings, Q&A sessions also involve in-person interaction. So, politeness is the basic principle of communication in this session. Avoid any expression that may threaten other peoples' face. "Could you please explain ...?" is much better than "I want to ask ..."; "I was wondering if you conducted the experiment in ..." sounds more polite than "Did you conduct the experiment in ...?"

With advanced technology, academic conferences are very often organized online nowadays. Politeness in language seems more important at virtual conference meetings than before. Both presenters and questioners can use non-verbal language at a conference in a real lecture hall, e.g., facial expression, gestures, etc., to guarantee smooth communication, but non-verbal language that can assist understanding seems impossible with the limited view of the camera at an online meeting.

Special attention should be paid to conversational strategies for the sake of politeness. Positive feedback is usually necessary in each conversation turn for both parties in the session. As you can see from the above Q&A session, for presenters, they should thank the questioners for their questions before they respond. For questioners, before asking the question, a compliment or a thank-you is also a good idea. It's especially the case when the questioners raise a different opinion from the presenters'. It seems more polite to start with an acknowledgement or agreement on some viewpoints, then to proceed to express different opinions.

Tasks

1. Discuss why Professor Li responded to the three questioners in different ways.
2. Discuss why questioners introduce themselves first before raising a question.

CULTURAL NOTES

Whether you're making or joining a group conference for the first or twenty-first time, you should always try to be as professional and polite as possible. But it can be confusing to know where you could go wrong. Here are some tips for you.

- **Present yourself appropriately.**

While many conferences can now happen remotely from your home, never sacrifice your standards for a professional appearance. Even if the conference only lasts a couple of hours, go the extra mile and wear business attire and style your hair and makeup appropriately. Not only will you be sure to present a professional face to the other members at the conference meeting, but chances are you will feel more alert and focused just on the act of cleaning up and preparing for the meeting. Standing or sitting with your webcam at eye level will also sometimes help you have a good, firm posture and speak clearly. Of course, make sure to turn on the camera when asking questions.

- **Be well prepared.**

Practice connecting and recording before your group conference if it is a virtual one. This will generally give you time to diagnose any problems you might have, like connectivity issues or problems with unflattering lighting in your location of choice. Otherwise, you would perhaps waste the time of all people.

Getting well prepared also means doing a little research about the presenter

or the talk in advance. In the process of research, you may come up with some questions. Whether these questions can be answered or not during researching, with all background information you acquire, it's more likely that you may ask questions more valuable for yourself and other attendees at the conference.

- **Introduce yourself by the name and affiliation before raising a question.**

Providing a little information about yourself is to show respect to the presenters, and to let them know how to address you. Also it helps the presenter decide what answer you need based on your identity.

LANGUAGE FOCUS

Language Feature: Politeness

For presenters, begin your response with a polite comment—when you respond, it is good practice to first thank the audience member for the question and/or acknowledge the question. Below is a list of polite comments for audience members.

- That's a great question. Thank you for asking.
- I appreciate your question.
- What a thoughtful question! I'm glad you asked.

For questioners, after introducing yourselves, start with positive comments on the presentation or just a thank-you before you raise a question. For example:

- 1) *Thank you so much for your excellent presentation, Professor Phillips. I'm Li Hua, a graduate student from the School of Civil Engineering, Southeast University. I'm so much impressed by the idea ... And my question is ...*
- 2) *I'm Ma Tian from Nanjing University. The solution to the problem is really mind-blowing. I would be very glad if you could give definitions to the essential concept of ...*

Useful Expressions

For presenters

- **Declaring the Q&A and inviting questions**

- 1) That's all for the presentation. Are there any questions?
- 2) Thank you for your attention to my speech. Now, let's come to the Q&A session.

- **Answering questions**

- 1) It's a good question. To answer your question, I would cite an example to explain ...
- 2) Thank you for your question. If I understand your question correctly, I can say that ...

- **Restating the questions**

- 1) Your question is ...? (rising tone)
- 2) Did you ask ...?

- **Asking to clarify questions**

- 1) I'm sorry. I didn't hear you clearly. Would you please repeat/clarify the question?
- 2) Sorry. I didn't quite get your first question. Could you say it again, please?

- **Answering questions partially**

- 1) Since time is limited, I would like to answer the last point of your question.
- 2) There is not enough time to go into details, but ...

- **Restating the ideas of your speech**

- 1) To answer your question, I would like to repeat the last point I made in my speech.
- 2) I'm very glad you asked this question. This is just the point that I want to explain again.

- **Dealing with difficult questions**

- 1) To be frank, it's a difficult question for me, since I am not familiar with the subject. I'm afraid I don't have an answer for you. Sorry for that.
- 2) That's a great question. I don't think it's appropriate for me to answer that now, but I'll happily discuss this with you in person after this session.

- **Dismissing questions politely**

- 1) It's an interesting question, but I'm afraid it is far beyond the theme of today's conference. So I'm afraid I couldn't answer it to your satisfaction. If you wish to discuss it with me after the meeting, however, I'll be happy to do so at that time.
- 2) I am very pleased at your interest in this subject, but in all fairness it's related to my privacy. So sorry, I have to dismiss your question.

- **Concluding the Q&A**

- 1) Our allocated time is almost up. Now I would like to answer one more question.
- 2) This is my answer to your question. I hope you are satisfied with my answers.

For questioners

- **Asking questions for clarifying problems**

- 1) I am very interested in the subject of your presentation. As you mentioned in your speech, ... What do you mean by saying that?
- 2) I don't quite understand what you really mean by saying that ... Can you explain it again?

- **Raising different opinions**

- 1) I agree with you about ... But so far as ... is concerned, I'm afraid I can't say that I go along with you on that. I would like to hear your opinion on this matter.
- 2) I am not an expert in this area. But I'm afraid there are other problems connected with the subject, which have not been mentioned in your speech.

- **Following up others' questions**

- 1) Just now Professor Wang asked you ... I'm also very interested in this subject. Would you please give us more examples to illustrate your ideas?

• **Asking questions showing special interest**

- 1) I'm keen on the theme of your presentation, especially the theoretical framework of your research. I would like to ask you two questions about it.

Tasks

1. Fill in the blanks with appropriate responses based on different situations.

Situation	How to respond
You didn't hear the question.	• Sorry, I didn't catch all that. • _____ 1) _____
You aren't sure about the details of the question.	• I don't quite understand ... • _____ 2) _____ • _____ 3) _____ • _____ 4) _____ • _____ 5) _____
You don't know the answer to the question.	• I'm sorry. I'm afraid I don't know the answer to that question. • _____ 6) _____ • _____ 7) _____
You don't want to answer the question publicly.	• I'm sorry. Could we discuss this issue after the session? • _____ 8) _____
Reviewing a part of your presentation.	• As I mentioned earlier ... • _____ 9) _____ • _____ 10) _____
Referencing a visual aid.	• Let's take a look at this figure again. • _____ 11) _____ • _____ 12) _____

2. Discuss on what occasions presenters give direct answers and indirect answers.

3. Translate the following sentences into English.

1) 这个问题不好回答,恐怕短时间内没法给你一个满意的解释。

2) 有意思,但是你的观点如何切合我们正考虑的问题呢?

3) 从你的问题判断,我能看出来你理解的 X 和我们完全不一样。我本意是……

4) 很高兴你对这个话题感兴趣,但凭心而论,我想咱们应该听听别人的问题。

5) 我回答你的问题了吗?

PROJECT

Raise 5 different types of questions, and answer them based on the keynote speech of your own group.

- An ordinary question
- A difficult question
- Raising different opinions
- Shifting the topic
- A follow-up question

CHECKLIST

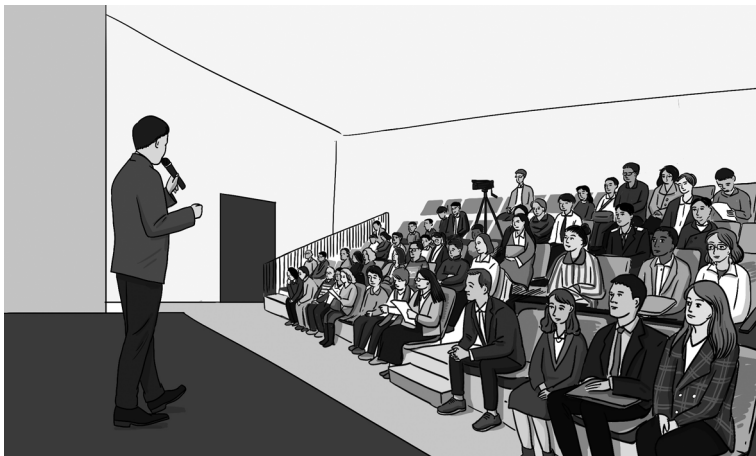
For presenters	☐	Prepare some questions in advance.
	☐	Declare the Q&A session at the beginning of the speech.
	☐	Make sure you understand the question.
	☐	Keep the audience on the topic.
	☐	Give direct answers if you can.
For questioners	☐	Introduce yourself.
	☐	Make remarks on the presentation.
	☐	Keep the questions concise and clear.
	☐	Show respect and politeness to the presenter.

Unit 9

Closing Speeches

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- To identify language features of closing speeches with proper examples;
- To write a closing speech with necessary components;
- To present a closing speech with appropriate expressions.



STRUCTURE

A closing speech is a formal talk given by a distinguished guest at the closing ceremony of a conference. Generally speaking, it includes several key components such as appreciation, summary, evaluation, expectation, invitation and declaration. The speaker usually gives thanks to all the related persons and organizations, makes comments on the contributions of the conference, sends notices of the arrangement for the next conference and delivers the declaration of close of the conference. Typically, the main function of closing speeches is to summarize the conference and to motivate participants to take action. Because the closing speech is the last thing that the participants will hear at the conference, it is vital to invite somebody to make it impressive and well-organized.

Sample Analysis

Here is the closing speech for the 2nd International Conference on Application of Smart Concrete.

Closing Speech	Components
Ladies and gentlemen,	• Salutation
The second International Conference on Application of Smart Concrete is now drawing to a close. I would like to take this opportunity to extend our sincere gratitude and appreciation to all of you, for your invaluable contributions in making this event a great success.	• Marking the closing of the conference

continued

Closing Speech	Components
We hope the past three days have been fruitful and that you will be able to make the most from the sessions you attended. Through a wide range of keynote speeches, tutorials, and discussions, we have been presented with new ways to deal with some of the challenges in application of smart concrete. We hope that you shared your experiences and expertise with other participants from near and far, and that a cordial relationship established among us during the conference will further strengthen.	• Summarizing the achievements
Through this conference we have seen that the application of smart concrete is vital for security and life time of the buildings. The application of smart concrete is the key of convenience, the essential symbol and requirement of new century buildings. As we return from this conference to our everyday activities, let's remember that we are part of the solution lie on smart concrete application. I am sure, the lessons learnt during the conference will equip us to respond to the complexity of technical, technological and theoretical challenges in the way of making our organizations compatible to requirements of wild applications of smart concrete in the new epoch.	• Making comments on the conference

continued

Closing Speech	Components
On behalf the conference team, we owe much to our distinguished speakers to you—the participants and presenters who have taken time out of your busy schedules to share your experience with us these days. Many of you have traveled long distances to be with us and we appreciate your willingness to openly share your knowledge and experiences. For some of us, this has been an opportunity to meet with our old friends, for others, an opportunity to make new friends who are working on similar area. We have had a chance to listen to some of the sessions over the past three days and was very pleased with the quality of the discussions that took place. As the organizers of the conference, I would like express our sincere thanks to our sponsors, without their support this event wouldn't take place. We wish them all the success in their work. I also express our gratitude to all members of the Organizing Committee and all staff of Southeast University extending exceptional hospitality to the delegates and maintaining high standards of arrangement for various events of the conference. Thank you for your efforts to this successful meeting. And I would also like to thank Chairman for his able chairmanship.	• Expressing gratitude/thanks

continued

Closing Speech	Components
But, of course, the real measure of this conference success lies in how it will affect you—our participants, or more precisely, how it will affect the actions you will take after you leave Nanjing. We, at Southeast University, look forward to further building partnerships with you and your organizations. I hope that all of us will continue what we have started here these days.	• Expressing expectations
Our next conference will be held in New York in March 2015, and I look forward to meeting you then.	• Inviting to the next conference
Thank you and have a good journey home!	• Giving good wishes

(<https://wenku.baidu.com/view/9535913501020740be1e650e52ea551810a6c91d.html>)

Tasks

1. Match each sentence with the corresponding component it demonstrates.

A. Salutation
B. Marking the closing of the conference
C. Summarizing the achievements
D. Making comments on the conference
E. Expressing gratitude/thanks
F. Expressing expectations
G. Inviting to the next conference
H. Giving good wishes

- 1) We are soon closing this seminar which has been a great success. ()
- 2) I wish to thank all the speakers, and other participants for their valuable contributions. ()
- 3) Honourable guests, ()
- 4) This conference successfully witnesses the fruitful cooperation among 40 countries. ()
- 5) And lastly, my friends, see you next year in Beijing, China for our next conference. ()
- 6) I hope you will have a safe and peaceful journey home and offer to you my warmest best wishes. ()
- 7) With the spirit and agreements of the conference, I hope we can promote a new innovation in this field. ()
- 8) We talked a lot, we discussed a lot and also we recommended a lot of things, such as ... ()

2. Match each paragraph of the following sample closing speech in Column A with a letter in Column B.

Column A	Column B
Mr. President Hu , Honourable guests, (1) I am now, on behalf of the organizing committee, to give the closing speech. (2) I believe that our conference is a great success. In these five days the conference has covered many advanced but difficult problems in the field of AI both theoretically and practically. All the presentations were very informative. And the heated panel discussions were fruitful. (3)	1. Appreciation 2. Invitation 3. Salutation 4. Summary and comments 5. Expectation 6. Purpose of the speech 7. Announcement

I hope that the result of the conference will push the research of AI to a new stage, and we need to maintain close contact and cooperation with each other in the future. (4)

As the chairperson of the conference, I deeply appreciate the members of the International Committee and the organizing Committee. (5)

Now, the conference is closed. Let's meet again in Beijing in 2023. (6)

3. Discuss with your partners to determine whether the sample closing speech and the closing speech in Task 2 are with the same components, whether their components appear in the same order, and whether they are used in the same situation. Please give reasons about your results.

CULTURAL NOTES

Closing ceremony and opening ceremony of an international conference are big and important occasions. There must be some etiquette worthy of attention.

- Participants should report at the meeting at the specified time, abide by the discipline of the meeting, and not be late or leave early. They are supposed to turn off or mute their mobile phone in the venue. No phone calls are allowed in the venue.
- During the meeting, please do not interrupt others' speech, do not doze off, do not whisper, do not play with mobile phones, and do not make noise or walk around at will.
- Smoking, spitting and littering are strictly prohibited in the venue to keep the venue clean.

- In order to ensure the quality of the meeting, please do not bring irrelevant personnel to the meeting.
- Take care of public facilities in the venue.
- In case of any violation of the discipline of the meeting place, the chairman of the meeting can stop it. If he/she refuses to make corrections, he/she may be ordered to leave the meeting place.

(<http://www.ccschy.com/jiaoyu/94750.html>)

LANGUAGE FOCUS

Language Feature: Positive vs. Negative

Positive	Negative
• As dictionary indicates, positive contains at least ten explanations in different situation. It here in this unit only refers to emphasizing what is laudable, hopeful, or to the good; constructive, such as positive information and positive attitude.	• As dictionary indicates, negative contains at least ten explanations in different situation. It here in this unit only refers to lacking in constructiveness, helpfulness, optimism, cooperativeness, or the like, such as negative information and negative attitude.
• Positive information and positive attitude can be specifically interpreted as success, good news, promotion, like, appreciation, welcome, best wishes, compliment, encouragement, etc.	• Negative information and negative attitude can be specifically interpreted as bad news, failure, degradation, dislike, disappointment, depression, depreciation, denial, cursing, criticizing, complaint, etc.
• Positive information and positive attitude are always demonstrated in a closing speech.	• Negative information and negative attitude are not frequently demonstrated in a closing speech.

continued

Positive	Negative
• Positive information and positive attitude are always delivered and expressed directly.	• Negative information and negative attitude are always delivered and expressed indirectly.

(<https://www.dictionary.com/browse/positive>)

From the table above, we can see that a closing speech, as a public speech, always expresses positive information and shows positive attitude to the participants. Even though some negative information and negative attitude will be mentioned in a closing speech, they will be shown indirectly.

Useful Expressions

• Expressing thanks

- 1) I wish to thank all the participants for your valuable contributions.
- 2) I would like to thank various people. First of all, the chairpersons for their efficient ways in which they handled their sessions. Second, the speakers for their excellent presentations. Third, the delegates for having been an excellent audience and having provided stimulating discussions. Last but not least, I would like to thank the companies for the financial support and cooperation we received in organizing and conducting this conference.
- 3) On behalf of all the members of our Organizing Committee, I wish to express our sincere gratitude to all of you who have so actively participated in this congress to make it such a success.

• Summarizing the achievements

- 1) Despite all of the unavoidable small difficulties, there have been a number of thoughtful and probing contributions in plenary sessions, and many first-rate seminars and roundtables on a certain number of subjects.
- 2) We talked a lot, we discussed a lot and also we recommended a lot of things, such as ...
- 3) In the past few days you have been addressing themes of paramount importance, and please allow me to express my admiration for and appreciation of your wisdom in these fields, since such wisdom is the basis

for action.

- 4) We have spent many hours and days debating and discussing 4,000 pages—yes, we have printed 4,000 pages in the conference proceedings. I am sure the output of so much work and effort will be productive, and result in concrete and tangible benefits to the need of the world.

• **Announcing the next conference**

- 1) I'm delighted to invite all of you to prepare to come to China in four years to participate in the ... Conference.
- 2) Our next conference will be held in Beijing at our college. We will try our best to make the forthcoming gathering another fruitful and pleasant one. I'm looking forward to meeting you then.
- 3) And lastly, my friends, see you next year in Nanjing, China, for our next conference.
- 4) I look forward to seeing you again at the next conference two years hence in Nanjing in 2024. You will be warmly welcome there.
- 5) Let us meet again in Paris in 2024 at the next world congress of applied linguistics.

• **Announcing the closing of the conference**

- 1) We are now very close to the end of this 3rd Conference of ...
- 2) Now with great joy and a mind reluctant to part, we get together again to declare that the conference has drawn to a successful close.
- 3) We are soon closing this seminar which has been a great success.
- 4) I now have the duty and the honour to declare the conference officially closed.
- 5) Now, the conference is closed. Let's meet again in Nanjing in 2023.

Tasks

1. Translate the following sentences into English.

- 1) 我们就要结束本次富有成效的会议了。

- 2) 我要感谢所有努力工作、奉献自我的员工,是他们使本次会议成为可能。

3) 几位主旨演讲人在本次会议主会场上做了关于物流实践的演讲, 非常有趣。

4) 听众虽然有大量的论文压力和时间压力, 但他们依然怀着极大的兴趣学习了科学家和商业专家们的研究结果。

5) 最后, 请允许我宣布本次会议胜利闭幕。

2. The following passages are from two closing speeches for the same conference. Compare the two versions, and discuss the two questions given below.

1) Which one is more suitable for a closing speech?

2) What leads to your answer?

Version A

Ladies and gentlemen,

... Dear friends, during the three-day conference, we have achieved several important agreements on global warming issues although there is still long way to go. We have learned the latest research tendency and the hottest research topics on global warming. It is obviously a successful conference ...

Version B

Hi, buddies,

... This conference hasn't achieved its goals and it's really bad in organization and full of complaints and anger and quarrels and disgusting results. Nobody can learn anything from it. It's obviously a complete failure. Let's finish it right now. Good bye.

3. Study the following closing speech which needs revision and work on the two tasks.

- 1) Discuss why it needs revision.
- 2) Rewrite this closing speech based on the discussion and what you have learnt.

Madam Chairperson ,
Your Excellencies ,
Distinguished Guests ,
Dear Friends ,

I am now , on behalf of the organizing committee of the 1st International Conference on the internet , to give the closing speech.

We are now very close to the end of the 1st International Conference on the internet which has achieved tremendous success so that we feel extremely happy and fulfilled and proud and honoured. It didn't go smoothly as scheduled. Many participants have come here unhappily to discuss not only general questions about the internet but more concrete questions and problems and their possible solutions. Some of the presentations were very illuminating and informative , but some were really unsatisfying and inefficient. Now with great joy and a reluctant mind to part , we get together again to declare that the conference has drawn to an unsuccessful close.

It is our hope that the result of the conference will carry the study of internet to a new stage and will benefit all people in this field. But unfortunately it seems that it's not as good as we expected. We all hope to maintain close contact and cooperation with each other in the future research in this field.

Now , I would like to express our sincere thanks with a little bit anger to the members of the Organizing Committee for all their support and contributions to this successful conference. Thanks to Teacher Bai , without whose guidance and instruction and supervision our conference would not be so successful. Thanks are also due to all the participants who came from different schools and majors.

Our next conference will be held in Shanghai in 2023. We are not that looking forward to meeting you there.

Dear friends , I hope you will have a safe and peaceful journey home and offer you my warmest best wishes.

I now declare the conference officially closed.

Thank you for your attention.

(Adapted from <https://www.docin.com/p-2412234871.html> & isPay=1)

4. Suppose you are Prof. Brown from Harvard University, USA. You are invited to make a closing speech for an international conference with the information given below.

(Adapted from the PPT of Closing Speech made by Department of Public English Teaching for Graduates, School of Foreign Languages, SEU)

The 20th International Conference on Parallel Data Processing

Host City: Nanjing, China

Sponsors: Computer Science Society of China

School of Computer Science and Engineering, Southeast University

Achievements:

- listened to 20 participants selected from 50 in the proceedings, which not only described problems, but also offered solutions;
- provided the chance to visit the School of Computer Science and Engineering, SEU;
- exchanged ideas with each other in the field of computer science;
- made friends with prominent scientists and experts all over the world;
- deeply impressed by laboratories and research centers of SEU.

The Next Host City: Boston, USA

PROJECT

Write a closing speech for a simulated international conference as part of your group work in the following suggested steps.

- Step 1** Make clear the title of the closing speech speaker.
- Step 2** Include the necessary components of the closing speech in the speech draft.
- Step 3** Write the closing speech with positive information.
- Step 4** Write the closing speech in formal English.
- Step 5** Practice and get ready to present the closing speech in the next class.

CHECKLIST

☐	Understand the structure of a closing speech.
☐	Tell the differences between positive information and negative information.
☐	Tell the differences between positive attitude and negative attitude.
☐	Get familiar with the necessary information components of a closing speech.
☐	Write a closing speech with necessary components and appropriate language styles.
☐	Be able to deliver a closing speech in public.

Appendix

Suggested Schedule for the Project

It is impossible to design a schedule that exactly matches arrangements of every group. But generally, there are 9 distinct steps in the process of organizing an international conference, requiring you to submit at least 4 hand-ins (scripts) over a period of 15 weeks. With some variations, many instructors observe the following schedule:

What You Must Do	What You Must Produce	When It Is Due
1. The group must decide on a conference theme and a keynote presentation topic.	Conference theme and the keynote presentation title	At the end of the 5 th week
2. The group must decide on the roles, and collect and review information for the conference.	Division of tasks; Necessary materials	At the end of the 7 th week
3. Preparing opening speech.	Speech script	At the end of the 8 th week
4. Preparing introduction of keynote speakers.	Speech script	At the end of the 9 th week
5. Preparing keynote speech.	Speech script	At the end of the 11 th week

continued

What You Must Do	What You Must Produce	When It Is Due
6. Preparing closing speech.	Speech script	At the end of the 12 th week
7. Script revision.	Final version of all scripts	At the end of the 13 th week
8. Preparing a PPT slide.	PPT	At the end of the 14 th week
9. Rehearsal.	Oral Presentation	At the end of the 15 th week

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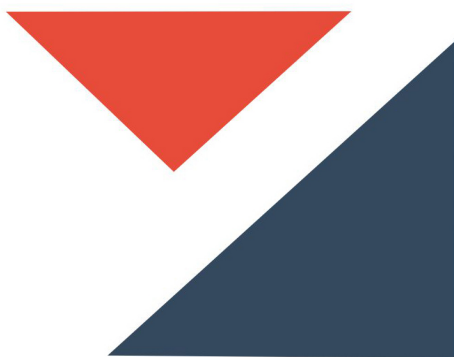


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